Sunday Pioneer

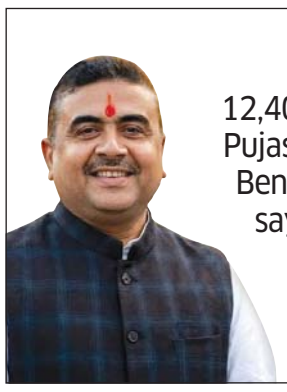
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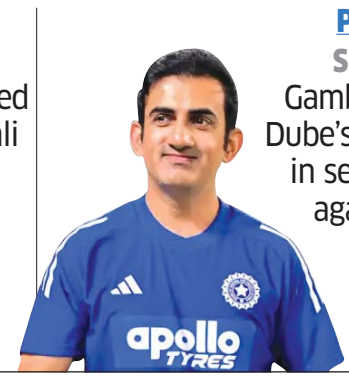
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PAGE 5
NATION
12,400 new Durga Pujas permitted in Bengal this year, says Suvendu



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GLOBAL
Gagan Thapa elected President of Nepali Congress



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SPORTS
Gambhir backs Dube's promotion in second T20 against WI

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COLOURS
The city welcomes Durga



AGENDA



DELHI SECURITY WALL FOILS CJP'S PROTEST PLANS

7,000 protesters detained, six police personnel injured



Police detain protesters during a demonstration at GoI Dak Khana in New Delhi



PANKAJ KUMAR/PTI

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP)-led protest, which drew keen interest across the country, failed to take off on Saturday amid an elaborate security umbrella across the national Capital.

The police detained the key leaders of CJP, AAP and TMC even before they could reach the designated site, Jantar Mantar. Police also picked up many others before they made it anywhere near the venue and whisked them away to makeshift detention centres and some stadiums.

By late afternoon, the picture was clear that the protest had fizzled out. Six Delhi Police personnel, including a female member of the Pink Force, sustained injuries during the detention of more than 7,000 protesters in different parts of New Delhi district. Police are likely to file multiple FIRs in connection with the alleged assault on police personnel during the protest, a senior officer said.



The tone of the preventive action by the police was set in motion right away in the morning when CJP leader Dipke along with Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained by a women's cop team after high drama from the plane after high drama when it landed at the Indira Gandhi International Airport.

Almost an hour before the CJP leadership arrived at Delhi airport, the outfit's supporter and YouTuber Dhruv Rathee was detained by Gurugram Police from his residence in Sector 56. According to the outfit, Rathee, who lives abroad, had travelled to participate in the demonstration.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Women cops detain CJP trio aboard AI flight

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

Dramatic scenes unfolded at Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport on Saturday when women officers of Delhi Police boarded an arriving Air India flight and detained three leaders of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) moments after the aircraft touched down. Police took Abhijeet Dipke, Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka into custody as they prepared to participate in the outfit's scheduled protest at Jantar Mantar.

Meanwhile, CJP on Saturday vowed to continue protests, announcing another demonstration at Jantar Mantar at 10 am on Sunday. Police boarded the plane just after it landed and went straight to the three people's seats.

The three men were escorted off the aircraft by the police and arrested, with no injuries reported and no major disruption caused to the other passengers. Airport authorities said the flight arrived on time and that normal disembarkation resumed after the arrests. However, they gave no additional information about the charges or the legal grounds for them. The detentions coincided with the group's announcement that it intended to hold a demonstration in the Capital.



WE ARE HERE TO BE ARRESTED, COME AND ARREST US
– ABHIJEET DIPKE

CONTINUED ON >> P4



ARVIND KEJRIWAL WAS DETAINED OUTSIDE HIS LODHI ESTATE RESIDENCE WHILE MARCHING TOWARDS JANTAR MANTAR WITH AAP LEADERS



IT'S VERY UNFORTUNATE. WE ARE NOT CRIMINALS; THEY PICKED US LIKE CRIMINALS
–MAMATA BANERJEE

SC to hear contempt plea on October 11

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



The Supreme Court will hear on Sunday a plea seeking to initiate contempt proceedings against authorities for allegedly violating the court's direction to ensure there is no "complete prohibition" of metro and train services due to CJP's protest in Delhi.

According to the cause list of October 11 uploaded on the apex court website, the plea is listed for hearing before a bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The plea, filed by advocate Shailendra Mani Tripathi, names Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar, and Delhi Metro Rail Corporation chairperson D Thara as respondents.

UN RAISES ALARM OVER DETENTIONS

The UN human rights office has raised concerns over mass detentions during large-scale protests in Delhi on Saturday, as it urged Indian authorities to respect the right to peaceful assembly and called for the immediate release of anyone arbitrarily detained.

The Permanent Mission of India in Geneva rejected the concerns, describing them as "misplaced" and an "unwarranted interference" in the country's internal affairs.

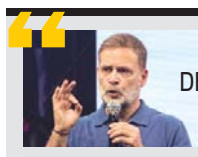


Security personnel keep vigil as heavy police deployment and entry restrictions in New Delhi
PANKAJ KUMAR

BJP calls CJP protest a flop show, Congress cries democracy muzzled

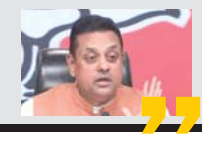
PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi/Chennai

With the CJP-led protest apparently having little impact in the national Capital, the BJP and the Opposition later traded claims. While the ruling party said the protest meant to hold the city "hostage" was a "flop show" and asserted India is not a "banana republic", the Congress charged the Government with turning the "mother of democracy into a "muzzled democracy" and urged the youth to keep protesting, asserting that the party is standing with them.



MOGAMBO MODI DESTROYING DEMOCRACY, WILL PAY FOR HIS CRIMES
–RAHUL GANDHI

IT WAS A VICTORY OF DEMOCRACY OVER MOB RULE
–BJP LEADER SAMBIT PATRA



The BJP said the protest meant to take the city "hostage" turned into a "flop show", accusing Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi of spreading anarchy in cahoots with foreign powers and likening him to Mir Jafar.

BJP leader Sambit Patra said it was a victory of democracy over "mob rule".

CONTINUED ON >> P4



IF ARRESTS ARE NOT LIFTED IN THE NEXT 24 HOURS, THEN EVEN I WILL BE COMPELLED TO THINK ABOUT A PEACEFUL DEMONSTRATION, WHETHER IT IS A PROTEST, A HUNGER STRIKE, A MARCH... IN LEH, OR IN DELHI
–CLIMATE ACTIVIST SONAM WANGCHUK

PIONEER IN SHORT

DELHI METRO REOPENS 45 STATIONS

The Delhi Metro reopened entry and exit gates at 45 stations after a 25-hour closure on Saturday, imposed due to the CJP's anti-CEC protest, with the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) announcing that gates across its network were now open. In a service update late Saturday, the DMRC said entry and exit gates at all Metro stations were open, and interchange facilities at all the concerned stations were also available. "The entry and exit gates of all Metro Stations of the Delhi Metro network are now open. The interchange facility at all the concerned Metro stations is also available," the DMRC said.

INDIA BLOC TO HOLD PROTEST ON MONDAY

The INDIA bloc will hold a protest march in Delhi on Monday against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh over the "vote chori" issue, while a delegation of its senior leaders will submit a memorandum to the Chief Justice of India seeking his intervention in the matter, Congress general secretary K C Venugopal said on Saturday. The Congress appeals to every Indian concerned about the survival of democracy to join the INDIA bloc's "massive" protest march in Delhi on Monday against the nationwide "vote chori" orchestrated by the Modi-Shah regime, Venugopal said on X.

Musk steps up attack on Ambani

Shares reports on alleged Reliance links to BJP campaigns, donations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



Elon Musk on Saturday continued his extraordinary swipes at Indian industrialist Mukesh Ambani, sharing screenshots of media reports that alleged a Reliance-funded firm helped boost BJP campaigns on social media and that a Reliance-linked company made large political donations to the ruling party.

The latest post by Musk on X featured an Al Jazeera report from 2022 headlined "How a Reliance-funded firm boosts BJP's campaigns on Facebook" and an archived Indian Express report from 2024 on Qwik Supply, which reported that the Reliance-linked firm donated ₹385 crore to the BJP and ₹25 crore to the Shiv Sena through electoral bonds.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Trump's oil deal exposes US double standards

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



Trump's decision to secure Russian diesel while penalising India for purchasing Russian crude has raised serious questions about Washington's energy policy, economic coercion and the selective application of sanctions.

US President Donald Trump faces criticism after announcing a deal with Russian President Vladimir Putin to import Russian diesel, despite previously imposing additional tariffs on India for buying Russian oil. The move has reignited debate over whether Washington applies its pressure on Moscow's energy trade consistently or prioritises American interests when domestic economic concerns arise.

On October 9, Trump announced that Russia would immediately supply more than 300,000 tonnes of diesel, with further shipments expected in the coming months. The announcement appears at odds with his administration's earlier justification for penalising India, which was accused of supporting Russia's economy through continued oil purchases.

In 2025, Trump imposed an additional 25% tariff on Indian goods, linking the measure to New Delhi's Russian oil imports. The administration argued that such purchases helped finance Moscow's war against Ukraine.

The latest development raises an uncomfortable question for Washington: if buying Russian energy supports Russia's military campaign, why should American purchases be acceptable while India faces economic penalties?

CONTINUED ON >> P4

NIA registers FIR to probe conspiracy in Flydubai cockpit attack

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has registered a First Information Report under Section 3 of the Anti-Hijacking Act, 2016, and Sections 16, 18 and 20 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) to investigate the mid-air attack on Indian pilot Captain Smit Machchhar aboard a Flydubai flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv.

The FIR, filed on the direction of the Ministry of Home Affairs, names the Omani first officer as the accused. It invokes provisions covering hijacking, terrorist acts, conspiracy and membership of a terrorist organisation. Officials said the agency will examine possible lone-wolf terror motives, radicalisation networks, the manner in which the plot was planned, and any wider conspiracy, including links that could point to an intended attack involving India.

Flydubai Flight FZ1073 departed Dubai International Airport at 7:05 am Gulf Standard Time on September 30, carrying 174 passengers, mostly Israelis, and six crew members. Captain Machchhar, an Indian national with more than a decade of commercial flying experience, was at the controls with the Omani first officer. Approximately two-and-a-half hours into the journey, near the Jordan-Saudi Arabia border, the first officer attacked the captain inside the locked cockpit, inflicting deep cuts to his head and hands.



Passengers later reported that the assault appeared to be an attempt to seize control of the Boeing 737 or deliberately crash the aircraft. The jet plunged more than 17,000 feet in under two minutes, briefly sending emergency codes including the hijack squawk 7500. Despite severe injuries and while still under attack on the cockpit floor, Captain Machchhar managed to open the cockpit door. Passengers and cabin crew rushed in, overpowered and restrained the first officer.

Two off-duty Flydubai pilots who were travelling as passengers took control and landed the aircraft safely at Prince Sultan bin Abdulaziz Airport in Tabuk, northwestern Saudi Arabia, around 10:45 am.

Saudi authorities arrested the first officer and later handed him over to UAE officials, who are still investigating the case. Reports name the accused as 29-year-old Omani national Hamam al-Hammami, also spelt Hammam al-Hammami.

Reports say Oman Air had earlier removed him from flying because of concerns about extremist material and radical views. Despite this, Flydubai later hired him and allowed him to fly the Dubai-Tel Aviv route. UAE officials have called the incident a terrorist act. Israeli authorities say there are signs of Islamist radical indoctrination and suicidal intent, and that the restrained first officer kept asking to be killed.

Captain Machchhar is in Dubai with serious injuries, but he is stable and recovering. During a video call with Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he described lying injured as the plane descended and making one last effort to open the door.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

2,947 bus marshals, 56 special buses for women: CM lists safety measures

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday that the Delhi Government has deployed 2,947 bus marshals on Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) buses and is operating 56 special buses for women as part of its safety measures. Of the 56 special buses, 15 operate during the evening shift, with armed women police personnel deployed on them after 5 pm, she said.

All buses are connected to the Bus Management System (BMS), with panic alarms, live CCTV feeds, and GPS monitored round the clock through a control centre, the chief minister said in a statement.

The Department of Women and Child Development will soon introduce additional accommodation facilities for working women in Vishwas Nagar and Rohini, she added. Highlighting measures to improve road safety and infrastructure, the chief minister said all buses are connected to the Bus Management System (BMS). The control centre monitors panic alarms, live CCTV feeds, and GPS round the clock.

Meanwhile, the Public Works Department (PWD) has installed 96,000 streetlights on roads, including 45,000 HPSV lights and 51,000 LED lights. The department has 2,53,983 CCTV cameras in operation. Citizens can also register complaints through the toll-free number 1908 and the PWD Seva Portal.

The Chief Minister said 11 One Stop Centres in Delhi assist women. Women's Helpline 181 has been linked with Emergency Helpline 112, One Stop Centres, Child Helpline 1098, Shakti Sadan and protection officers to ensure coordinated assistance when needed.

In Delhi, Child Helpline 1098 is linked to Emergency Helpline 112, child care institutions, and District Child Protection Units. The city has 30 Government-run and 56 non-Governmental child care institutions. In addition, one after-care home for boys and one for girls are available.

She said Child Welfare Committees and Juvenile Justice Boards are functioning as statutory bodies to protect children's rights. Eleven District Child Protection Units work to connect children in need with assistance, protection, and rehabilitation.

She also said that 15 women's shelter homes are operational in Delhi. Keeping working women's needs in mind, 14 working women's hostels are available, with a combined capacity of 2,427.

Sub-Divisional Magistrates have been designated as Child Marriage Prohibition Officers to prevent child marriage, while schools have around 1.5 lakh CCTV cameras to improve children's safety and confidence, she said.

The chief minister added that 1,397 schools are providing self-defence training under the Rani Lakshmibai Self-Defence Training Programme. She also highlighted the multi-layered safety network, including the Women's Helpline 181, DTC services, and child-protection measures.

BJP ex-MLA's daughter among 7,000 detained

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Yashaswinee Raje Singh, whose father is former BJP MLA Vikram Singh from Fatehpur Sadar in Uttar Pradesh, was detained by Delhi Police on Saturday during a major crackdown on protests calling for Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar to resign.

Yashaswinee wrote on X that police detained her near Bangla Sahib 'for sitting in a park' and took her to Keshav Puram police station. She later posted a video saying the incident happened around 11 to 11.30 am and claimed police were detaining people at random, even those just sitting on benches.

Her detention was part of increased security across Delhi before a planned protest at Jantar Mantar organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

This is not the first time Yashaswinee has been involved with CJP activities. Earlier this year, she became known during the June and July student protests at Jantar Mantar, which called for Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign over alleged exam paper leaks.

As a content creator, she openly supported the CJP campaign and joined related protests.

Reports say she keeps her political views separate from her father's and rarely talks politics with him.

Armed with posters, goggles and raincoats, protest veterans guide first-timers



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

With digital posters, political artwork, and advice on how to protect themselves, many protesters who took part in the July demonstration returned to support those joining the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) latest stir in Delhi on Saturday, hoping to join a protest that unfolded amid heavy security and mass detentions. Some made posters at home, while others created digital artwork focusing on illegal imprisonment and the absence of name tags on police personnel, while also preparing for scenarios such as a lathi charge.

Those who had experienced the earlier demonstration advised newcomers to carry at least two masks, swimming goggles, raincoats, and clothes they would be comfortable getting wet in, anticipating possible police action in response to their posters.

"We had participated in the July protest, so this time we wanted people joining the demonstration to be better prepared. Many of us have also been making political artwork and posters at home for people to carry during the protest," a protester said.

Hardik, who participated in the earlier demonstrations, said he had created digital political artwork ahead of Saturday's protest, focusing on issues such as alleged illegal detentions and police personnel not wearing name tags. He had also prepared for possible scenarios, including a lathi charge.

"As we fight for the freedom we once celebrated in cinema, we remember the tears our nation shed as our forefathers fought an exploitative regime. Today, we carry the torch of non-violence through the dark alleys of fascism once again," he said.

"Most of my friends are women, and given how unsafe it feels today, I will be fighting for them as well. I am sure this protest will continue for a while. I made posters advising people to carry at least two masks, swimming goggles, raincoats and clothes they would be comfortable getting wet in, keeping in mind the possibility of police action," he added.

Hardik had also participated in the protest demanding the resignation of former Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan and the July 20 march to Parliament. But Saturday's planned gathering at Jantar Mantar did not take shape on a large scale. Delhi Police denied permission for the demonstration, citing inadequate notice and concerns over compliance with rules during an earlier protest.

For protesters returning after July, even finding one another proved difficult, with updates largely circulating through social media.

Although Jantar Mantar remained largely inaccessible to demonstrators, the posters, artwork and advice brought by returning participants offered a glimpse of how the earlier protest had shaped preparations for the next, with those who had been there before trying to ensure that newcomers did not have to face the uncertainty alone.

Barricades, checks, diversions: Central lanes choke amid protest call

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Vehicles crawl in a heavy traffic jam on the Delhi-Gurugram Expressway near the Sirhaul Toll Plaza along the Delhi-Gurugram border as police set up barricades for security checking in Gurugram on Saturday PTI

Amid the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) call for a protest at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, Delhi Police imposed traffic restrictions on most roads leading to Central Delhi, especially Jantar Mantar and Parliament Street, from early morning, with barricades, vehicle checks and diversions slowing movement on several roads.

At every road leading to the protest site, police personnel, along with paramilitary forces, were seen deployed in large numbers to monitor traffic and prevent any gathering in the vicinity. Though the footfall was low in the city, heavy traffic congestion was reported across several parts of central Delhi due to tightened security arrangements.

Apart from curbs, police are also conducting searches at various spots and key stretches leading to the protest site, which has caused congestion.

While senior officials maintain they are ensuring no trouble for regular commuters, traffic around Central Delhi is moving very slowly. Forces manned the barricades to closely monitor vehicular movement across the capital. They checked ID cards and other documents before allowing entry to those having offices in central Delhi.

The heightened security came amid traffic curbs, metro restrictions, train cancellations and a mobile internet suspension in central and other parts of the national capital to "maintain law and order" in view of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) call for a protest on Saturday demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

The entry was restricted at stretches including Connaught Place, Ashoka Road-Jantar Mantar Road roundabout, Tolstoy Marg-Janpath crossing, Jai Singh Road-Sansad Marg crossing, Rail Bhawan rounda-bout, Patel Chowk, Gol Dak Khana, Windsor Place, Mandi House, the Chelmsford Road-Sansad Marg intersections, the Barakhamba Road intersection and the Minto Road-Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg junction.

The restrictions further included Bharion Road-Mahatma Gandhi Marg intersection, Lodhi Road flyover, Neela Gumbad roundabout, Madarsa T-point, Samrat Hotel roundabout, Sardar Patel Marg-Panchsheel Marg crossing, the underpasses beneath the Bhikaji Cama Place and Moti Bagh flyovers, and the Ring Road-San Martin Marg intersection.

The diversions, which began at 6 am, will be regulated based on the prevailing law-and-order situation.

According to the traffic advisory, the affected stretches include the Ashoka Road-Jantar Mantar Road roundabout, Tolstoy Marg-Janpath crossing, Jai Singh Road-Sansad Marg crossing, Rail Bhawan roundabout, Patel Chowk, Gol Dak Khana and Windsor Place.

Traffic movement may also be affected at Mandi House, the Chelmsford Road and Sansad Marg intersections with Connaught Place's outer circle, the Barakhamba Road intersection and the Minto Road-Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg junction. Other locations include the Chelmsford Road-Connaught Place outer circle intersection,

Bharion Road-Mahatma Gandhi Marg intersection, Lodhi Road flyover, Neela Gumbad roundabout, Madarsa T-point, Samrat Hotel roundabout, Sardar Patel Marg-Panchsheel Marg crossing, the underpasses beneath the Bhikaji Cama Place and Moti Bagh flyovers, and the Ring Road-San Martin Marg intersection.

Visuals showed a heavy police presence around the protest site early in the morning, with personnel stationed along the roads and at barricades across the city. Traffic continued to move smoothly as police kept a close watch on vehicles entering and leaving the area, stopping and checking some cars.

Commuters have been advised to avoid non-essential travel and allow extra time for their journeys. Those travelling to railway stations, inter-state bus terminals or the airport through New Delhi and central Delhi have been asked to plan accordingly.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Dated: 09.10.2026

Notice is issued on behalf of **Mr. Deepak Miglani** concerning **Seikom Infracom Private Limited** ("Seikom") and the **Bally Hai project,** situated at Plot No. GH-07, Sports City, TechZone-IV, Greater Noida. Disputes arising from the Term Agreement dated 17.04.2024 concerning Seikom's shareholding, management, control and projectrelated contractual rights are pending before:

NCLT, New Delhi: CP-177/241-242/ND/2026 and connected proceedings.

Delhi High Court: O.M.P.(I) (COMM.) 468/2026 under Section 9 of the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996.

A related complaint is also under enquiry before EOW, Delhi Police.

Mr. Miglani challenges his purported removal and related corporate changes. The authority of **MMR Construction Company Private Limited,** Mr. **Mohit Raghav, Royce Buildwell Private Limited,** Mr. **Vipin Chaddha** and their representatives or nominees to create third-party rights affecting Seikom, the project or the disputed contractual entitlements is contested in the pending proceedings.

Accordingly, banks, NBFCs, financial institutions, lenders, prospective investors, purchasers/allottees, brokers and the public are cautioned against sanctioning or disbursing fresh loans, investing funds, making fresh bookings or purchase payments, or creating or accepting mortgages, charges, pledges, assignments, transfers or other third-party interests affecting Seikom's shares, project land, development rights, inventory or receivables without independent legal and financial due diligence, inspection of the pending proceedings and verification of requisite corporate, GNIDA, RERA and statutory approvals. Government departments, statutory and registration authorities are requested to take note of these disputes when considering related applications or approvals.

This notice does not assert that any injunction has been granted or that the disputes have been finally adjudicated. Proposed transactions may be affected by judicial orders. Existing lawful allotments, contractual payment obligations, settlements and judicial orders remain unaffected; existing allottees should pay lawful dues only into duly authorized statutory project accounts.

Issued solely for caution and preservation of rights, without admission or waiver. All rights and remedies of Mr. Deepak Miglani are expressly reserved.

Sincerely Yours,
[C. S. Chauhan]
Counsel for Mr. Deepak Miglani
New Delhi

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Email: chhinnbhalchauhan@gmail.com
Office: 515, 5 th Floor, Indra Prakash Building, Barakhamba Road, New Delhi - 110001.

BALLY HA'I
Plot No. GH-07, Sports City TechZone-IV, Greater Noida

The Pioneer CLASSIFIED

CHANGE OF NAME

I, hitherto known as SAHIL BABBAR S/O ANIL BABBAR R/O GALI NO. 14, D-370, THIRD FLOOR, LAXMI NAGAR, SHAKARPUR, EAST DELHI, DELHI-110092 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as SAHIL SAMY.

I, Hasseena Begum, Mother of- No.16018284H Hav Halim Khan, R/o- Vill- Naya Nagla, Post- Bhaurajpur, Dist- Kannauj, U.P.- 209720, have changed my name from Hasseena Begum to Hasina Begam, vide affidavit dated 10/102026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Khant Kokilabahen Vijaybhai W/o- No.14865716K NK/MT Khant Vijaybhai Balvantbhai, R/o Vill: Juna Mahelan, PO: Sajivav, TA: Shahera, Dist: Panchmahal, Gujarat- 389210, in my husband's Army Record my incorrect name is recorded as Damor Kokilabahen Vaghabhai Sartanbhai Damor whereas my correct name is Khant Kokilabahen Vijaybhai which may be amended accordingly.

I, Sunita W/o- No.15420117A Hav Dongare Gorakh Madhav, R/o- A/P- Nimgaon Wagha, Tal & Dist- Ahmednagar, Maharashtra- 414005 have changed my name from Sunita to Sunita Dongare, vide affidavit dated 10/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Archana W/o Vinay Kumar Suryan, R/o- WZ-101/11, Mohan Nagar, Pankha Road, New Delhi- 110046, have changed my name from Archana to Archana Suryan for all purposes.

I, Ritesh Kumar Suryan, S/o Vinay Kumar Suryan, R/o- WZ-101/11, Mohan Nagar, Pankha Road, Nangal Raya, South West Delhi, Delhi- 110046, have changed my name from Ritesh Kumar Suryan to Ritesh Suryan for all purposes.

I, JC-452878M Sub Shiv Bachan Yadav of 18 Grenadiers C/O 56 APO R/O Gram- Mahadaha Babhagwanpur, Post- Haroura,Teh- Mehnagar, Dist- Ghazipur, Uttar Pradesh- 276126 declare that my daughter's name is wrongly mentioned as Khushi in my service records and her correct name is Khushi Yadav for all future purposes vide affidavit before Public Notary Delhi 09-10-2026.

I, Sameer, S/o Jummadin, R/o C-27/3, Near Makki Masjid, Madanpur Khadar Extn, Part-3, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi-110076, declare that my name is incorrectly mentioned as MD Sameer in some documents, whereas my correct name is Sameer.

I, Masroor Ahmad, R/o R-162, 3rd Floor, Lane No. 6, Sir Syed Road, Jogabai Extension, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi–110025, hereby declare that my name has been incorrectly mentioned in my son Arhan Ahmad's Class XII marksheet as "S. Masroor" instead of my correct name, "Masroor Ahmad." Both names refer to one and the same person.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public on behalf of our client i.e. ICICI Bank Ltd. that Mr. Naveen Kumar husband and Minor son Ritul Choudhary are jointly to be claiming owners of Entire Third Floor with roof rights, (the said floor), area measuring 48 Sq.mtrs. of Property No.139, Block-B, Pocket-6, Sector-3, Situated at Rohini, after demise of late Mrs. Rinky who was owner of the above floor vide a sale deed dated 26.08.2016, registration No. 8228, All Persons are hereby informed that above owners wants to sale the said floor to Madhvi Sehgal who is taking a home loan facility from our client against the said floor. if anybody has any objection/s upon the ownership of above owners, its title/ its sale/ mortgage & any other kind of objection/litigation, Charge etc., kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 10 days of the present.

Kumar & Associates (Advocates & Consultants)
200, IInd Flr. 23, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, N.Delhi-15
legal@knalegal.com Ph: 011-41112527-28

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Vinay Kasana had acquired Residential House land measuring 250 sq. yds., i.e. 209.03 sq. mtrs., Khasra No. 247, situated in the Village Bhangel Begampur, Tehsil Dadri District Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh vide Gift Deed dated 18.11.2025 executed by Mr. Sunil Kasana w.r.t said property. Now Mr. Vinay Kasana is the undisputed owners of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

TO WHOM SO EVER IT MAY CONCERN

This is to inform the general public that Kisetsu Saison Finance (India) Private Limited., having its branch office at Noida, U.P., intends to extend a financial facility to Mr. Tarun, against the security of Plot/House of Land area measuring 2 Marla i.e., 61 Sq. Yds., (Property Id No. 3PLQBRO3), Out of Mustatil/ Khasra No. 1435/2 (1-2), situated at Waka Mauja Palwal (Shyam Colony), inside Hadd Nagar Parishad Palwal, Tehsil and Distt. Palwal, Haryana. The Sale Deed dated 11.04.1990, executed by Mr. Lakhmi Chand S/o Mr. Ram Chand in favour of Mr. Devi Ram S/o Mr. Shree Chand in respect of the Said Land i.e., Land area measuring 2 Marla, Out of Khasra No. 1435/2 (1-2), vide Document No. 139 on 12.04.1990, duly registered in Sub Registrar Palwal, has been misplaced by Mr. Tarun. An FIR regarding the loss of the aforesaid document has already been lodged vide Application No. 1326007125O1327. Any individual or entity in possession of the aforementioned Original Sale Deed dated 11.04.1990, is requested to return it at the earliest. Kindly contact Advocate Bhupander Kumar at + 91-8295949981 within 7 days from the date of this notice.

Bhupander Kumar (Advocate)
Contact No- +91- 8295949981.
Email Address: -legal1@ridhiassociate.in

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that Mr. Dharambir is the owner of Property ID-1COU2N23, Property area measuring 527 Sq. Yds, Situated at Mauza Village Fazilpur Jharsa, andar Abadi Lal Dora, Sub-Tehsil Badshahpur, District Gurugram, Haryana through Transfer Deed dated 31.10.2023 doc. no. 10753 executed by Mr. Surjeet Singh in favour of Mr. Dharambir in respect of Said property.

Mr. Dharambir is in the process of mortgaging the said Property with SMFG India Credit Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client. If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in.

LOST & FOUND

I, **Anamika Jha, W/o Ghanshyam Jha, R/o D2 0306, Amrapali Golf Homes, Greater Noida West, Gautam Budha Nagar, U.P.,** hereby inform the general public that the **Flat Transfer / Endorsement Documents pertaining to flat allotted by Amrapali** have been lost/misplaced in Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P. on 23.07.2025 between 10:00 AM to 12:59 PM. If it will be found by anyone please contact @9899258348.

Anamika Jha, W/o Ghanshyam Jha,
R/o D2 0306, Amrapali Golf Homes,
Greater Noida West, Gautam Budha Nagar, U.P.,

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of our client **Mr. Sanjay Kumar Khemka** original property documents w.r.t. Property No. B-108, Area 289 sq. yards, Malviya Nagar, Delhi-110017 including Allotment Letter, Possession Letter, GPA, ATS & Will (Tek Chand to Kanwal Bhatia), GPA & Will (Kanwal Bhatia to B. R. Abhyankar), Will dt. 01.11.1971, Probate Order, Death Certificate & SMC of Late B. R. Abhyankar, have been lost/misplaced. Any person who finds the aforementioned documents, or who holds a valid claim, objection, or right regarding the concerned property, is requested to inform the undersigned in writing within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. Failure to do so will be construed as an absence of claims, and the process regarding ownership rights/documents will be proceeded with in accordance with the law.

Ranjan & Company
Advocate
"KING's COURT" B-247, 3rd Floor,
Priyadarshini Vihar, Delhi-110092
011-43632804, 43632805, 9311022100

[[Pursuant to rule 30 the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]
Adv. to be published in the N.P. for change of regd. office of the Co. from one state to another Before the Central Government DELHI Region
In the matter of the Co. Act, 2013, Section 13(4) of Co. Act, 2013 and Rule 30(6) (a) of the Co. (Inc.) Rules, 2014
AND
In the matter of GANGOTRI COLONIZERS PVT. LTD. having its regd. office at A-72 LGF Chittaranjan Park, N. D.-110019 Petitioner
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Co. proposes to make app. to the Cent. Govt. u/s 13 of the Co. Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the MOA of the Co. in terms of the special resolution passed at the AGM/ EGM held on 01st Oct 2026 to enable the co. to change its Regd. office from "State of DELHI" to "State of U. P.".
Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the regd. office of the co. may deliver or cause to be delivered or send by regd. post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the Reg. Director B-2 wing, 2nd Floor, Pt. Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan,CGO Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003, within 14 days from the date of publication of this notice with a copy of the applicant co. at its regd. office at A-72 LGF Chittaranjan Park, New Delhi -110019.
For and on behalf of the Applicant
Gangotri Colonizers Pvt. Ltd
Director: Satish Kumar Sahani
(00751704)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the' General Public that Shri Nirmal Kumar Sharma S/o Shri D.L Sharma. Rio House No. 436, Sector 21 A. Faridabad, Haryana, hereby declares the withdrawal, cancellation and revocation, of all his previous Wills, Agreements, Transfer Documents, Undertakings, Post-Dated Cheques, Promissory Notes and other documents/instruments executed or issued by him in favour of any person, concerning properties situated at Chandigarh, Haridwar, Delhi, Haryana or elsewhere, or relating to any financial Transaction, claim, liability or dispute.
All previous Public Notices, declarations, announcements and objections issued or published by him or on his behalf, concerning any property, transaction, claim, dispute or any other matter whatsoever, are also hereby expressly withdrawan, cancelled and superseded through this Public Notice, Any person having any claim, objection, dispute or pending transaction concerning the above may contact Shri Ratneshwar Kumar, Advocate, Mobile: 7503851573, or Shri Shrey Sudan, S/o Shri Nirmal Kumar Sharma, Mobile: 8447292278, within 60 days from the date of publication, along with supporting documents.
Thereafter, claims based upon such withdrawn/revoked notices or documents shall not be acknowledged or entertained by Shri Nirmal Kumar Sharma.

Through Advocate
Ratneshwar Kumar
Chamber No. 1503, Rohini Courts,
Delhi Mobile: 7503851573
Email: adv.ratneshwar@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Mohd Sarfaraz has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Mohan Co-operative, New Delhi. (Bank) to avail a Loan for purchase of First Floor & Second Floor with roof rights of Property No. 12, Model Basti, Jhansi Road, New Delhi from Mr. Ashwin Jain who has represented that he is the absolute owner in possession of the said property having inherited from his father through Will dated 23.10.2020 (Doc-604). Letter of Administration dated 07.11.2025 has also been granted to him by The Hon'ble Court of Ms. Shivali Sharma, District Judge-06 (Central), Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi. He has further represented that the Memorandum of Total Partition of Hindu Undivided Family dated 22.07.1996 has been misplaced/lost and FIR bearing LR no. 636725/2026 dated 16.09.2026 has been lodged with P.S Crime Branch, Delhi. If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said property on the basis of lost document/s or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 15 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.

Amit Kumar, Advocate
Narang & Associates
D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

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Sunday Pioneer
NEW DELHI | SUNDAY | OCTOBER 11, 2026

Protesters hide in gurudwara, washrooms to dodge detention

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

They hid in public washrooms, took shelter overnight in a gurudwara and slipped in and out of its gates as police closed in, turning the crackdown during the CJP protest in Delhi into an elaborate game of hide-and-seek.

Delhi Police chased Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protesters attempting to reach Jantar Mantar, detaining several as they regrouped and tried to evade the security cordon. Some scrambled to evade detention, using public washrooms and taking shelter in a gurudwara, slipping in and out of its gates to lie low.

The protest was scheduled to begin at 10.30 am. Still, the police and paramilitary forces deterred the participants from reaching the Jantar Mantar site, which has been turned into a fortress, by detaining several and sending back many more. As protesters, many of them women, attempted to regroup at different locations, police chased them down and detained them in buses.

One of the most unusual scenes unfolded at an NDMC washroom in Connaught Place, where more than 20 young protesters had hidden overnight, hoping to sneak through the extensive security arrangements ahead of the march to Jantar Mantar.

The group gradually gathered overnight after the city announced restrictions on Friday. The washrooms, locked at 10 pm and reopening at 6 am, offered a temporary hiding place until police checks in the morning thwarted their plan.

During an inspection, police found the protesters inside the washroom. Some allegedly forced the door open to get in. The protesters were rounded up and bundled into detention vehicles.

Most had their faces covered. Even after being detained, they continued raising slogans and banging against the interiors of the police vehicles, their voices carrying through the netted windows that shielded those inside from public view.

The episode at Connaught Place was one of several scenes across central Delhi where protesters tried to avoid police custody, only to return to the streets as soon as they saw an opportunity.

At Gurudwara Bangla Sahib, young protesters who had taken shelter overnight repeatedly emerged from the premises to join demonstrations before retreating inside as police personnel pursued them. The cycle continued as the two sides moved back and forth around the gurdwara, with protesters attempting to evade detention.

Slogans of "*Inquilab Zindabad* " and "*Jai Bhim* " rang out in the lane outside the gurudwara as a large group of protesters poured onto the street. Within minutes, police detained several of them.



Demonstrators raise slogans as security personnel stand guard in Connaught Place during a protest in New Delhi on Saturday PTI

The gurudwara had offered refuge to student protesters earlier in July, when they were demanding the resignation of erstwhile Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan. This time, protesters took shelter there after citywide restrictions were announced on Friday, preparing to join Saturday's demonstration.

Police also approached representatives of Bangla Sahib and asked them not to allow protesters onto the premises, according to those familiar with the exchanges. The gurudwara representatives refused, saying the protesters were unarmed and were not raising slogans inside.

"We won't let police enter the premises. Protesters are unarmed and not raising slogans inside the premises, so we are not against them," a representative said.

The presence of police personnel carrying lathis near the place of worship and the detention of young protesters drew criticism from some visitors, who called the action shameful and questioned the decision to pursue demonstrators in the vicinity of a religious site.

The protesters' attempts to find refuge were not confined to the gurdwara. Several youth organisations and student groups marched from Baba Kharak Singh Road to Ashoka Road, as police personnel moved in to detain them. Some protesters ran into the gurudwara premises as officers approached, seeking shelter before attempting to return to the demonstration.

At Kerala House, several CPI(M) leaders, including former chief ministers of different states, had been staying since Friday night. Police detained them on Saturday when they stepped out to join the protest.

The scenes played out against an unprecedented security deployment around the planned demonstration, called by the CJP and other Left organisations to demand Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise. Over 30,000 police and paramilitary personnel were deployed across the Capital, while 45 metro stations were closed and traffic restrictions imposed on 30 road stretches around Jantar Mantar. Police pickets dotted the city, with identity checks and vehicle inspections at border points, railway stations, bus terminals, hotels, and other sensitive locations.

Police also placed steel spikes on some roads to prevent vehicles from forcing their way through checkpoints without inspection.

Scooty rides, long walks and detours to reach protest site

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Two hours on a scooty, a long walk from Nizamuddin after an auto ride, and a cab journey that went round in circles before finally dropping its passenger near the protest site — people found different ways to reach central Delhi on Saturday, determined to raise their voices against alleged irregularities in voter rolls.

With roads leading to New Delhi barricaded, vehicles stopped or were diverted, and several metro stations shut, many found it difficult to reach the protest site at Jantar Mantar. Buses continued to ply in parts of the city, but police did not allow vehicles into several areas of New Delhi.

At Tolstoy Marg, where the road leading to Jantar Mantar was barricaded, a group of protesters who had reached the spot stood around, occasionally breaking into slogans. As police personnel approached to detain them, some tried to run, only to be caught up in another round of detentions. Meer, who travelled from Sarita Vihar on a scooty, said the journey had taken two hours and he had to park about three kilometres from the spot.

"We are the youth of this country. If we don't come, who will?" he said, explaining why he had made the effort despite the restrictions. Safhana, a Delhi University student living in Laxmi Nagar, said she reached the area in an auto around 6 am, carrying food, water, and other essentials.

She had come with eight others. Three women from their group were detained, she said, adding that they had managed to contact them but did not know which police station they had been taken to. "We ran," she said, describing the moments when protesters tried to evade the police.


Security officials stops commuters amid protest in New Delhi PANKAJ KUMAR

Altamas, who claimed to be a student of Jamia Millia Islamia University, said he travelled through narrow lanes in an auto before being dropped near Nizamuddin. From there, he walked for around two hours to reach the protest area.

"During British rule, we read about repression. Today, we are witnessing how repressive it can be," he said. He said he had come not for himself but for the country, invoking former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee's words that "Governments will come and go, but the country must endure".

"People must continue to believe in institutions," he said, stressing the importance of universal adult franchise. For 21-year-old Harshit, the issue was also personal. He said he had applied for a voter ID card but was told he could not get one because of an address-related issue.

He took a cab from the AIIMS area, but the driver kept taking detours before bringing him towards the protest site. The driver did not take payment immediately and asked him to pay after reaching home, Harshit said.

"We were sitting peacefully, but we were asked to move," he said, recalling how protesters were removed from the spot. He added that he had attended earlier protests as well. The restrictions also affected people who were not participating in the demonstration.

A woman working with MTNL said she had walked from New Delhi to reach her workplace. She was on duty on the second Saturday of the month and had to report for essential services work.

She was stopped at the Janpath-Connaught Place intersection, where she had walked from the New Delhi Railway Station for around 1.5-2 kilometres, but was later allowed to go. At Connaught Place, Nilesh Navlakha, a filmmaker from Pune, said he had travelled to Delhi because he felt he should witness what he believed was a historic moment.

Slogans on streets, drones overhead as protesters play hide-and-seek with police

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

The lane in front of gurudwara Bangla Sahib filled with slogans a little after 1 pm. "*Inquilab Zindabad* " and "*Jai Bhim* " rang down the road as protesters stepped out of the gate in numbers. Police then came out from behind the gurudwara walls, also in large numbers, and began pulling people away from the entrance. Within ten minutes, police detained the protesters.

Many of them had been inside since the night before. After restrictions were announced on 9 October, they took shelter in the gurudwara to be in position the next morning. One of them was a 24-year-old woman in a mask. She said the group had been there since 9 am, after finding Jantar Mantar barricaded. Throughout the morning, she and others stepped out in small groups to chant slogans. They scattered whenever *khaki* came into view and came out again a little later.

The city around the gurudwara had been closed down from the night before. Entry and exit gates at about 45 Metro stations, among them Central Secretariat, Janpath, Rajiv Chowk and ITO, were shut from 9 pm on Friday until 6 pm on Saturday. Even so, people had already gathered at Jantar Mantar around 1.00 pm.

By 8.30 am, police had begun picking up those collecting near the protest site and putting them on buses. Nearby, a notice announcing Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita was pinned to a barricade. Police personnel patrolled, and a police van stood parked. Drones were up, and mobile internet had been cut within a four-km radius of Jantar Mantar. Police said they had detained 150 people by mid-morning. They said New Delhi had been divided into 20 zones, each with its own detention centre, and that stadiums across the city were also being used. Among the vehicles pressed into service were grilled buses normally used to ferry undertrials to court.


A Delhi Police official launches a drone for aerial surveillance to monitor security and crowd movement along Parliament Street during a protest in New Delhi on Saturday PTI

Around 11 am, police detained a group of lawyers marching from the Supreme Court towards Jantar Mantar. The Supreme Court Bar Association took the matter to the Chief Justice of India. By 1 pm, he and the Solicitor General had spoken to authorities about releasing the lawyers.

On Janpath Road, three layers of barricades and thousands of security personnel stood across the way. A protester named Nikhil, whose second visit this was, had spent the night mapping routes. He took a cab from Vasant Kunj to Bangla Sahib and walked the Outer Circle to Connaught Place. At Janpath, he found the barricades. CAPF and CRPF personnel held the site and the surrounding roads.

Throughout the day, protesters of different ages kept trying to get through. Some had come with their families. One brought her younger sister to show her that people can still come together and raise their voices.

About six students from Hindu College waited near Janpath Metro station.

Over 7,000 detained as protest splinters across Capital

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The plan was to assemble at Jantar Mantar, but it didn't happen. A sea of khaki and blue-green fatigues, metal barricades and buses parked askew across the streets turned India's address of dissent into a fortress on Saturday, scattering protesters across Delhi. Small groups raised slogans, changed routes and tried to regroup, only to be detained. By 5 pm, police had detained at least 7,000 people.

With heavy security deployment preventing protesters from reaching the designated venue, what was meant to be a collective gathering soon split onto streets, intersections and alternative meeting points across the Capital. Saturday's protest was the latest in a series of demonstrations that have rocked New Delhi this past week, including one by Congress activists led by Rahul Gandhi. The INDIA opposition bloc is scheduled to hold a new protest on Monday.

A previous CJP protest in July against competitive examination paper leaks forced the resignation of then Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan after young men and women camped at Jantar Mantar for days. Mindful of that protest's success, the Government, on Saturday, placed central Delhi under a much larger, tighter security grip, shutting down metro services, suspending trains from outside New Delhi, and blocking mobile Internet services.

From Connaught Place and Gurdwara Bangla Sahib to Dilli Haat, Gole Market, INA Market and Minto Bridge, the protesters moved between locations, searching for places to assemble and trying to find others who had set out for Jantar Mantar.

Capital will not be held hostage: CM slams Rahul, Kejriwal over protest bid

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Amid a crackdown on anti-CEC protests, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Saturday said the Capital would not be held hostage and accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and AAP supremo Arvind Kejriwal of trying to turn the city into a "battleground" in league with their "B-Team" CJP.

Top CJP leaders, Kejriwal, along with leaders of Left parties and Trinamool Congress, CJP members, activists and students were among over 7,000 people detained as authorities foiled a planned protest by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar to demand resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

CJP convener Abhijeet Dipke and Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained at Delhi airport on their arrival from Mumbai.

The chief minister, in a post on X, alleged that Gandhi and Kejriwal, rejected by the people, sought to turn Delhi into a battleground in collusion with their "B-Team". "Why are these leaders so hell-bent on venting frustration over their nonstop defeats on the public? What offence have residents of Delhi committed to be tormented by the chaos on the streets?" Gupta wrote.


Security personnel keep vigil as heavy police deployment and entry restrictions are enforced ahead of a planned protest CJP members in New Delhi on Saturday PANKAJ KUMAR

She asserted that she will fight resolutely against the politics of spreading anarchy in the guise of democracy and challenging the public mandate. She also hit out at Kejriwal, accusing him of trying to disrupt safety and peace in Delhi for his "political self-interest".

"Arvind Kejriwal, who worships anarchy and has bestowed upon himself the title of Delhi's owner, is attempting to disrupt the peace and security of Delhiites for his political self-interest," she charged. Kejriwal, along with several of his party's leaders, was detained after he tried to march to Jantar Mantar.

The chief minister questioned who would be responsible for the trouble caused to people heading to work, daily wagers trying to support their families, and patients trying to reach hospitals amid the protests.

"Are your political ambitions greater even than the livelihoods, safety and peace of millions of families in Delhi?" she asked. "Delhi voted for development. Due to the unprecedented public support, Prime Minister Narendra Modi became Prime Minister for a third consecutive term," the chief minister said.



Sunday Pioneer
NEW DELHI | SUNDAY | OCTOBER 11, 2026

Viksit Bharat possible through inclusive growth: Vice President

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Deoghar (Jharkhand)



Vice President CP Radhakrishnan speaks during the Sainya Sampark Mela Sadaiv Aapke Saath organised by the Indian Army to support veterans, Veer Naris and their families in Deoghar PTI

Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan on Saturday said the vision of 'Viksit Bharat' can become a reality only when all states, districts and villages develop together.

He said Jharkhand could emerge as a powerful centre of inclusive and sustainable development with the right investment in education, healthcare, skills, technology and entrepreneurship.

"Prime Minister Narendra Modi has a vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. It can become a reality only when every state, district and small village develops together. Access to quality healthcare and higher education for tribal communities and rural folk lies at the heart of the mission," Radhakrishnan said while addressing the second convocation of AIIMS, Deoghar.

He said it is the fundamental right of every citizen to have the best healthcare.

"Over the last decade, the country witnessed an unprecedented expansion of medical education and healthcare infrastructure. New AIIMS and medical colleges have been set up, there has been a rapid increase in MBBS and post-graduate seats, and flagship missions such as Ayushman Bharat brought health insurance to the poorest households," he said. Earlier, there was only one AIIMS in the country. Now, the number has increased to 12, and more will come up, the VP said.

"The number of medical colleges has more than doubled from 387 in 2014, when Prime Minister Narendra Modi took charge, to 846 now," he said.

Radhakrishnan said the number of MBBS seats increased from 5,100 to 1.39 lakh, and the number of post-graduate seats from 31,000 to around 86,000 during the same period.

He urged students to carry their learnings beyond the walls of their institutions to the villages and the most distant corners of the country. The institute conferred degrees upon 50 MBBS, 94 BSc, 12 MSc and eight Doctor of Medicine (MD) and Master of Surgery (MS) students on the occasion.

Later, the VP visited the Sainya Sampark Mela — Sadaiv Aapke Saath — in Deoghar, organised by the Indian Army in collaboration with the Deoghar district administration to provide welfare services and grievance redressal facilities to ex-servicemen, 'Veer Naris' and their dependents across the Santhal Pargana region, an official release said.

India-US trade pact to be finalised keeping changed circumstances in mind, says Goyal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The US and India announced in February that they had reached a framework for an interim trade agreement, but circumstances have changed, and the pact will be finalised accordingly, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Saturday.

He also said that trade pact negotiations are on with number of regions including Israel, Chile, GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council) and Russia-led group Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU).

"USA (trade pact) February me announce hua. Thodi paristhitiyan badli hain, usko abhi madde nazar rakhte hue final hoga. (It was announced in February. Some circumstances have changed; the final decision will be made keeping that in mind)," Goyal said here while addressing members of industry chamber PHDCCI.

India is seeking lower tariffs for its goods than its competitors in the American markets. The minister did not elaborate about those circumstances, but the changing tariff landscape in the US has led to further negotiations about the first phase of bilateral trade agreement (BTA) between India and the US.

Goyal earlier this month met US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer on the sidelines of G20 trade mister meeting in Milwaukee. Both discussed trade pact-related issues. Further, the minister said that negotiations for a trade pact with Canada are moving at a faster pace and talks for an agreement with South Africa-led SACU group will start soon.

Several countries are keen to negotiate trade agreements with India, he said adding talks with Mexico will be launched next week. Goyal informed that the trade ministers of the UK and Canada will be visiting India next week. India and the UK implemented a trade agreement in July. The UK minister will be here for the India-UK Joint Economic and Trade Committee (JETCO) meeting.

The Union Minister slams Congress leader Rahul Gandhi for his claims and statements after meeting President Droupadi Murmu.

"It was an objectionable behaviour ... He has insulted the President ... This is a sense of anarchy," Goyal said, adding that the opposition leaders have misbehaved with security personnel. A delegation of INDIA bloc leaders met President Murmu on Friday evening and handed her a memorandum on the alleged "vote chori".

After the meeting, Gandhi said he was shocked and stunned that the President did not deny the "election theft" charge and "accepted" what the opposition leaders stated.

Mumbai to host UK-India CETA Marketplace

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai



Mumbai will host the first UK–India Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) Marketplace on October 13, bringing together senior UK cabinet ministers, seven mayors from Northern England and more than 100 British businesses to explore trade and investment opportunities between the two countries. Hosted by Harjinder Kang, His Majesty's Trade Commissioner for South Asia and British Deputy High Commissioner for South Asia, the event will showcase British innovation, products and services while translating the landmark trade agreement into tangible commercial opportunities.

The marketplace will feature businesses and institutions from sectors including advanced manufacturing, clean technology, healthcare, fintech, education, consumer products and infrastructure. It aims to connect UK and Indian companies, facilitate partnerships and help businesses access new markets.

"The UK–India trade deal has opened an exciting new chapter in our economic partnership. The CETA Marketplace is about bringing that opportunity to life, connecting businesses directly with the products, expertise and partnerships that can drive growth," Kang said. The agreement provides for tariff liberalisation on 90 per cent of UK goods exported to India, while 99 per cent of Indian goods exported to the UK are set to benefit from duty-free or reduced-tariff access, according to the initiative's details. Key benefits include duty-free access for Scottish salmon in India, reduced tariffs on Scotch whisky and significant tariff reductions for British automobiles.

Sashi Mukundan, Executive Vice President of Rolls-Royce India, said the agreement would create greater opportunities for trade, investment and collaboration.

FROM PAGE - 1

Delhi security wall foils CJP's protest plans

Several opposition leaders, including former chief ministers Arvind Kejriwal (AAP), Mamata Banerjee (TMC), Pinarayi Vijayan (CPI-M) and Manik Sarkar (CPI-M), were detained from multiple locations across the capital as they tried to join the protest called by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), throwing the protest into disarray and dampening the expected turnout.

Jantar Mantar, a designated protest site, wore a deserted look throughout the day, with the deployment of over 40,000 security personnel and waves of barricades in Lutyens' Delhi to keep the protesters away from the area.

At Jantar Mantar, security personnel outnumbered protesters, detained about 500 people as they attempted to reach Jantar Mantar despite authorities denying permission to protest there. Several protesters were chased and detained as they tried to regroup at different locations and evade the security cordon.

From Connaught Place and Gurdwara Bangla Sahib to Dilli Haat, Gole Market, INA Market and Minto Bridge, the protesters moved between locations, searching for places to assemble and trying to find others who had set out for Jantar Mantar. At several points, slogans rang out before police personnel moved in, chasing protesters and detaining them. Unlike the July protests, however, police did not use force, and no violence was reported.

As the police chased, the protesters scrambled to evade detention, using public washrooms, taking shelter in a gurudwara, and slipping in and out of its gates to lie low. One of the most unusual scenes unfolded at an NDMC washroom in Connaught Place, where more than 20 young protesters had hidden overnight, hoping to sneak through the extensive security arrangements ahead of the march to Jantar Mantar.

At Gurudwara Bangla Sahib, young protesters who had taken shelter overnight repeatedly emerged from the premises to join demonstrations before retreating inside as police personnel pursued them. The cycle continued as the two sides moved back and forth around the gurudwara, with protesters attempting to evade detention. Slogans of "Inquilab Zindabad" and "Jai Bhim" rang out in the lane outside the gurdwara as a large group of protesters poured onto the street. Within minutes, police detained several of them.

The protest was scheduled to begin at 10.30 am. Still, the police and paramilitary forces deterred the participants from reaching the Jantar Mantar site, which has been turned into a fortress, by detaining several and sending back many more. As protesters, many of them women, attempted to regroup at different locations, police chased them down and detained them in buses.

High drama unfolded at Delhi's IGI Airport as minutes after an Air India flight carrying Abhijeet Dipke and his team, including Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, landed, Delhi Police personnel entered the aircraft and moved in on the group. Dipke, who said he was prepared to be arrested before he arrived, stood his ground as police approached him. "I was prepared for arrest. Main kisi se darta nahin hoon (I'm not afraid of anybody)," he said. In a video clip shot on the plane, police were seen entering the aircraft Dipke was travelling in, creating chaos on board. The flight had landed at Delhi's Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport around 11 am on Saturday.

Kejriwal was detained by the Delhi Police outside his residence while he was marching towards Jantar Mantar to participate in the protest. Mamata Banerjee, along with TMC joint secretaries Derek O'Brien and Dola Sen, Rajya Sabha MP Samirul Islam, Lok Sabha MP Pratima Mondal and former MP Saket Gokhale, held a dharna at a bus stop on South Avenue.

Vijayan, CPI(M) General Secretary MA Baby, senior CPI(M) leader Brinda Karat, Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas and Former Tripura Chief Minister Manik Sarkar were among the Left leaders detained as they headed to join the protest. CPI(ML) Liberation General Secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya, AISA president Neha, along with activists Yogendra Yadav and Prashant Bhushan, were detained from Dilli Haat near INA market.

Some lawyers trying to march towards Jantar Mantar were also detained. However, the Congress stayed away from the CJP's planned demonstration. Rahul travelled to Chennai to attend an event involving his ally and Tamil Nadu chief minister Vijay.

Around 1 pm, scores of protesters hurled stones at security personnel near the Akashwani Bhawan on Imtiaz Ali Marg after jumping barricades, injuring two police personnel. The protesters were quickly detained by security personnel.

In the evening, a similar incident happened near Hanuman Temple in Connaught Place, where some protesters threw stones at security personnel. A total of seven personnel sustained injuries during the detention of protesters. Deputy Commissioner of Police (South) Anant Mittal also sustained injuries to his hand during the detention of Left leaders, including AISA's Neha.

In a pre-recorded video message released soon after his detention, CJP leader Dipke said the organisation's in-charge, Ajinkya Shinde, would lead its protest at Jantar Mantar. The CJP asserted that the protest would continue nationwide, with or without its leaders.

Several journalists claimed that they were detained. Reporters alleged that they were detained despite displaying their press identity cards, and that their official phones were seized by police personnel before they were taken to detention buses along with other protesters. Visuals circulating showed journalists displaying their press identity cards from inside the buses.

The partial lockdown-like situation was marked by the closure of 45 metro stations, traffic diversions and heavy barricading along 30 road stretches in the areas around Jantar Mantar. Delhi's borders were also tightly secured, with heavy police deployment. Police personnel also used steel spikes on some roads to prevent forced entry without vehicle inspection.

Women cops detain CJP trio aboard AI flight

According to people involved in the operation, the Delhi Police top brass may have expected resistance and wanted to minimise the risk of a physical altercation in the tight aisles, where even a small fight could quickly involve other passengers and crew.

The CJP, a minor political group, had announced plans to gather at Jantar Mantar, a site long used for public demonstrations. The fact that the police decided to intercept the leaders while they were on the plane indicates they had prior knowledge of their journey and chose to act before they could reach the terminal or the protest site.

Carrying out such an operation inside an aircraft cabin is uncommon, suggesting the aim was to prevent immediate public mobilisation upon arrival.

The operational method seems to have been influenced by the physical conditions of the situation. With little room to move, it would have been hard to control any struggle.

Female officers may have been included to reduce the chance of immediate resistance or to delay escalation. The decision to deploy them was a deliberate tactical move.

A broader trend of preventive policing is underway against groups attempting to gather at Jantar Mantar, with permits and security measures strictly enforced.

Because of the arrests, the main organisers of the CJP event were removed from the picture so they could not join their supporters or speak at the gathering. By Saturday evening, it was still unclear whether the protest would go ahead without them or whether authorities would produce the three before a magistrate.

The situation shows that city authorities have to continually find a balance between allowing lawful assemblies and keeping order in the capital; in the limited space of a commercial aircraft, this balance was achieved within a short time by a group of officers who got on the plane, identified the people in question, and took them away before the majority of the passengers had left their seats.

BJP calls CJP protest a flop show, Congress...

Addressing a press conference at the party headquarters, Patra called Rahul Gandhi a "nalayak" leader, condemning his Friday remarks that President Droupadi Murmu did not deny the INDIA bloc's "vote chori" allegation at a meeting.

"What is happening at Jantar Mantar and what is being shown on TV and across various social media handles does not represent the true story of India. India is peaceful, and India is moving forward with good governance," Patra said

He alleged an attempt to hold the capital and the whole of India hostage through the protests.

"There were attempts to incite violence, physical altercations, and street battles here. It remained a flop show.

"Democracy triumphed over mobocracy (mob rule). Given the way democracy has asserted itself in Delhi today, and the fact that the entire situation is under control, I wish to reiterate that the anarchists failed. Their show flopped," he added.

Patra hit out at Rahul Gandhi, likening him to Mir Jafar, a betrayer, citing his recent remarks on Elon Musk's Starlink project in India.

He alleged that Rahul Gandhi is "welcoming" Musk to India today, even as his party leaders earlier questioned the Government's move to license the Starlink project in India.

Patra also likened other opposition leaders, including those of Left parties and AAP convenor Arvind Kejriwal, to Mir Jafar, alleging that while Rahul Gandhi is spreading anarchy in a bid to come to power without winning elections, Left leaders like Brinda Karat are creating "ruckus" over baseless 'vote chori' allegations because they "run their households from the extortion money collected through Naxalism", which the Modi government has ended.

Attacking opposition parties, Patra alleged, "It is Modi versus the Mir Jafars today." Patra alleged the Mughals and the British usurped power in India because of "such Mir Jafars".

"But Modi is here, and it is Modi alone who will save this country from the British and infiltrators. It is absolutely clear that in this battle of 'Modi versus Mir Jafars', people of India stand with Modi ji and the nation. This is because Modi ji draws his strength from 140 crore Indians, and works for their welfare," he said.

BJP spokesperson Ravi Shankar Prasad called it a "victory of the people" and said India is not a banana republic. Under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, this country has never bowed and never will," Prasad said, defending the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of voter rolls and Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the demand for whose resignation is at the centre of the wave of recent protests.

"Based on the events of today and the preceding three days, two things have become clear," he said. "One, Indian democracy has thwarted attempts to incite anarchy. Two, the country will be governed by Parliament, not by the streets," he explained, citing bypoll victories of the BJP-led NDA's wins in Assam, West Bengal and Puducherry on Friday. "All these elections took place while this entire mischief was unfolding in Delhi over the past several days. The BJP wishes to particularly highlight that this stellar performance in Bengal, Assam, and Puducherry occurred while a movement for anarchy was underway in Delhi and other parts of the country," he argued.

"We are not opposed to protests, but you have weaponised street protests because of your electoral defeats," he said, naming the Congress, though he did not name the CJP.

Slamming the police crackdown on protestors, the Congress accused the Government of turning the "mother of democracy" into a "muzzled democracy". It said the "seva teerth" is a fast-crumbling "satta teerth".

The opposition party claimed that the "PM-HM duo is extremely nervous and rattled" by a peaceful protest and so the Government has "officially waged war against its own people".

The Congress also condemned the detention of several political leaders and protesters. In a social media post, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge said, "Our youth, students, lawyers, journalists, social activists, farm union leaders, YouTubers, content creators, everyone who is questioning this regime are being detained.

"The Modi Government has turned the 'Mother of Democracy' into a 'Muzzled Democracy'."

Kharge alleged that the "cowardice" of the BJP-RSS is on full display today. "The Congress Party, along with the united Opposition, will fight this tyrannical regime, tooth and nail," the Congress chief said. Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, who is in Chennai, said Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will go, and so will the Modi government, and then democracy will begin to heal. In a post, he also tagged a video clip of his speech to INDIA bloc MPs on Friday at the Central Hall of Parliament.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh, in a post, wrote, "Seeing what is happening in the nation's capital today, it is tempting to recall the old saying 'vinash kale viprit buddhi' (When a person's doom has come, judgment becomes self-destructive). But the fact is that this 'viprit buddhi' is what has defined the 'Diabolical Duo' for years. "The so-called 'Seva Tirth' (PMO) is actually a fast crumbling 'Satta Tirth'."

"The PM-HM (Narendra Modi-Amit Shah) duo is extremely nervous and rattled by a peaceful protest by youth deeply concerned with the planned stealing of their Constitutional right to vote guaranteed by Article 326," he said. Congress general secretary KC Venugopal alleged the "Modi-Shah regime has officially waged war against its own people".

Trump's oil deal exposes US double standards

The deal comes as rising energy costs place pressure on the US administration. According to figures attributed to the American Automobile Association, average American diesel prices reached $6.28 per gallon, following a record high of $6.53 in late September.

Trump said the Russian supplies would help bring fuel prices down for American consumers, farmers and truckers, underscoring the importance of affordable energy to the US economy.

However, India has long maintained that it makes energy decisions based on national interest, affordability, and supply security.

India imports nearly 90% of its crude oil, making access to competitively priced supplies essential to its economy. According to the Global Trade Research Initiative, Russian crude accounted for 30.3% of India's oil imports in fiscal year 2026, valued at $40.8 billion.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has previously argued that Washington itself encouraged India to purchase Russian oil in 2022 to stabilise global markets. New Delhi has also questioned why Indian purchases attract criticism while Western countries continue trading with Russia. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky criticised the reported arrangement, warning that Russian petroleum revenue could help sustain Moscow's military campaign.

The controversy exposes a fundamental contradiction in international energy politics. While Ukraine seeks to restrict Russia's war financing, Governments remain concerned about domestic fuel costs and economic stability.

For India, the dispute reinforces its argument that energy security should not justify selective economic punishment. For Washington, the challenge is to explain why policies presented as essential to pressuring Russia appear different when American interests are involved.

NIA registers FIR to probe conspiracy...

He said he was fighting for his life but would not let others die. Both Modi and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu praised his actions for preventing a disaster.

The NIA can investigate this case under the National Investigation Agency Act because the victim is an Indian citizen and the offences are listed in the Act, even though the incident happened outside India.

"Investigators plan to request the cockpit voice recorder, flight data recorder, and the suspect's electronic devices with help from Saudi Arabia and the UAE. They will also review the first officer's background, digital activity, work history, and any links to radicalisation to determine whether the attack was planned and part of a larger network", sources familiar with the probe said.

Musk steps up attack on Ambani

The latest post comes amid Musk's scathing criticism of Mukesh Ambani over a persistent delay in the launch of Starlink satellite broadband services in India.

Reliance has not publicly responded to Musk's allegations. At the same time, the Government has maintained that the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services is "fair and non-discriminatory" and that any suggestion that it was being applied selectively was "baseless and misconceived".

At the India Mobile Congress this week, as Musk's dramatic confrontations and swipes played out on X in the backdrop of India's swanky annual showcase of its telecom prowess, Reliance Jio Infocomm Chairman Akash Ambani declined to comment on the ongoing debate over satellite communication services, saying the company was focused on delivering value to Indian consumers.

A few hours before he made the post, Musk on X addressed Mukesh Ambani as "Prime Minister Ambani" and accused him of protecting a monopoly. Musk asked whether Ambani would consider letting his satellite internet service compete with his company in the country.

On Friday, Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia asserted that India does not permit monopolies in any sector, and that despite the buzz around one particular company, three players have received satcom licences and can start operations after meeting the security requirements and milestones.

Sunday Pioneer
NEW DELHI | SUNDAY | OCTOBER 11, 2026

124 ex-bureaucrats back ECI, SIR

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



A total of 124 former IAS, IFS, IPS and allied services' officers have strongly defended the Election Commission of India (ECI) and the SIR process, saying a system cannot be honest when someone wins and rigged when that person loses.

In an open letter to the citizens of India, the former officers also said institutions cannot be judged on the touchstone of political affiliation.

They said under the same commission, the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)at the Centre lost Assembly polls in Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Telangana, Jharkhand and Jammu and Kashmir, and in 2024, lost its majority in the Lok Sabha.

"The winners raised no complaint. A system cannot be honest when you win and rigged when you lose," they said.

The officers, including former secretaries to the Government of India, former ambassadors, former directors general of police, former chief secretaries of states and former directors general of income tax, also said errors must be corrected, but the legitimacy of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral roll is settled.

They said the SIR is a cleanup operation that sanitises voter lists and weeds out ineligible voters, bringing some discomfort in the process, which is part of every major initiative to improve the health of India's democracy.

The signatories to the letter included former foreign secretary Kanwal Sibal, former Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officers RD Kapur, Samirendra Chatterjee, Gopal Krishna, Vivek Bhardwaj and Navneet Sehgal, former Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officers Bhaswati Mukherjee and Prabhu Dayal, and former Indian Police Service (IPS) officers K Aravinda Rao and Sarvesh Chandra.

Highlighting India's transformation from an era of booth capturing, ballot-box stuffing and electoral violence, the officers said today's electoral system has multiple layers of checks and safeguards, including polling agents, EVM sealing, strong-room security and VVPAT verification.

They cited last year's Bihar Assembly polls, which recorded no re-polling and the highest voter turnout since 1951.

Strongly defending the ECI's independence, the officers highlighted its multi-member structure and institutional safeguards.

"Questioning is every citizen's right. Proving is the accuser's duty," they asserted. On the SIR, the officers said the exercise is essential to clean up the electoral roll. They highlighted the identification of around 22 lakh deceased voters and seven lakh duplicate entries in Bihar, alongside the addition of approximately 21.5 lakh new voters. "An uncleaned roll does not protect the voter. It protects fraudster," they said.

The officers also highlighted the safeguards available under the SIR, including notices, hearings, appeals and the participation of political parties' booth-level agents.

They pointed out that the Supreme Court has scrutinised the exercise, prescribed additional safeguards and, according to the letter, upheld the ECI's authority to undertake it.

In a pointed message to those questioning poll results, the officers said, "If the system you call rigged is the same one that handed you your victories, ask yourself whether it is the system you doubt, or only the result."

The officers said they have prepared voter lists, trained polling parties, sealed strong rooms and supervised the counting of votes.

Undeclared emergency: Wangchuk warns of protest if detainees not released

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk on Saturday described the situation in the country as an "undeclared emergency" after authorities detained several Opposition leaders, student activists, lawyers and journalists in Delhi amid sweeping restrictions ahead of a protest demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation over alleged irregularities in electoral rolls.

Wangchuk, who had appealed for peace and unity ahead of the demonstration, condemned the detentions and said he would consider launching a peaceful protest, including a hunger strike or a march in Leh or Delhi, if those detained were not released within 24 hours.

"A few moments ago, I learned that student leaders, youth leaders, lawyers, journalists, and even MPs have been arrested in Delhi today," he said in a video message posted on X.

"Yesterday, when I gave you a message to maintain peace and unity in today's demonstrations, I believed that a peaceful demonstration would be allowed in the world's largest democracy. But now, it seems as if there is an unannounced emergency all over the country," he said.

The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) called a demonstration demanding Kumar's resignation, accusing him of masterminding voter-list manipulation during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral roll and other irregularities related to Form 6, used for voter registration.

Heavy security deployment and restrictions were imposed in the national Capital. Authorities detained several Opposition leaders, including former chief ministers Arvind Kejriwal, Mamata Banerjee, Pinarayi Vijayan and Manik Sarkar, as they attempted to join the protest.

Wangchuk urged the Government to end the detentions and resolve the issues through dialogue. "I condemn this very much and request the Government to end these arrests. The issues should be resolved by this evening," he said.

"If arrests are not lifted in the next 24 hours, then even I will be compelled to think about a peaceful demonstration, whether it is a protest, a hunger strike, a march... in Leh, or in Delhi," he said.

Rahul meets TN CM Vijay to cement alliance

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Chennai

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi met TVK president and Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay at his suburban Neelankarai residence on Saturday, party sources said.

Gandhi spent about an hour with Vijay, and the two discussed several political issues. Later, they visited Bask by Coffee, a cafe in the neighbourhood and reportedly had a Cappuccino, Tiramisu, cookies and coffee.

Neelankarai is a posh, quiet locality near the beach on the city outskirts, close to the East Coast Road.

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha then went to a hotel in the city. In the evening, Gandhi travelled to the sprawling Island Grounds for the youth outreach programme, Chhatron Ki Goonj (Maanavargalin Kural).



Security forces recover huge arms, explosives cache in north Kashmir



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Jammu

Intensifying its ongoing counter-terrorism operations, a joint team of security forces recovered a huge cache of arms, ammunition and explosive material in the North Kashmir district of Baramulla on Saturday. Acting on specific intelligence inputs generated by Sopore Police, a Cordon and Search Operation (CASO) was launched in the forest area of Mukaam Cherhar, in Sopore township of the north Kashmir district, a police spokesperson said.

He said the searches resulted in the recovery of a major cache of arms, ammunition, grenades, Improvised Explosive Devices (IEDs) and other related material.

During the search operation, a blue barrel and a bag were found concealed beneath a large boulder, he said. A Bomb Disposal Squad (BDS) was immediately called to the spot for examination and safe handling of the suspected explosive material, the spokesman said.

The recovered material included two assault rifles – an AK-47 and AK-76 – along with seven magazines and ammunition, four pistols along with four magazines and ammunition, a multi-grenade launcher (MGL) with five rounds, 11 hand grenades, three IEDs with remote controls, eight detonators and two timers, he said.He added that other material, including a Y-SMS set, prima cords, wires, battery cells, IED-related components and miscellaneous accessories, was also recovered.

A case FIR No. 66/2026 under Sections 13, 18, 20 and 23 of the UAPA, Section 7/25 of the Arms Act and Section 5 of the Explosive Substances Act has been registered at Police Station Bomai, he said.

12,400 new Durga Pujas permitted in Bengal this year: CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kolkata



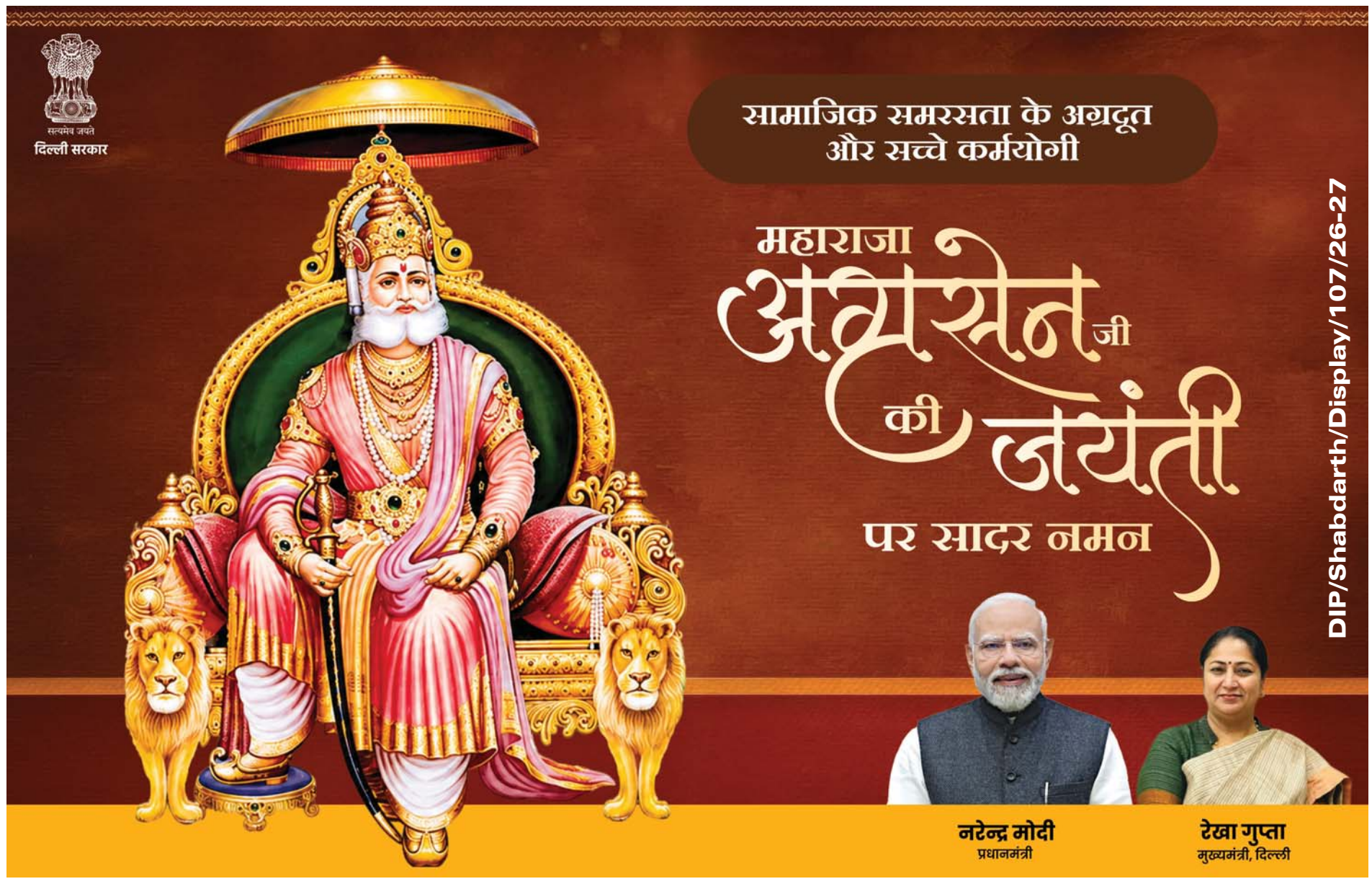
West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Saturday said his Government had granted permission for 12,400 new Durga Pujas this year and all of them had received financial assistance from the State.

Speaking at a special programme marking the beginning of 'Debipaksha' at the Eden Gardens here, Adhikari said around 45,000 Durga Pujas were held in the State last year.

"Earlier, (during the previous Government) to hold Durga Pujas, one had to approach the Calcutta High Court to get requisite permission. It was sad. I do not think there is a single such case this time. Compared to the number of Durga Pujas held in 2025, this year we have 12,400 new pujas," he said.

"In our Cabinet meeting, we decided that Durga Pujas will not commence during Pitripakkha, which is why we inaugurated it today during Debipokkho. We had decided that this year, besides the cultural aspects of the puja, we will also follow the customary rituals as per the traditional Hindu astrological almanac," Adhikari said.

Pitripaksha is the fortnight dedicated to honouring ancestors through rituals such as 'tarpan' and 'shraddha', while Debipaksha marks the auspicious period associated with Goddess Durga and the lead-up to Durga Puja.





Fresh attack hits Saudi Arabian capital's airport

SAMY MAGDY ■ Cairo



The airport in the Saudi Arabian capital, Riyadh, was attacked again on Saturday and evacuated, two regional officials said, two days after three Saudi citizens including a pilot were killed as the kingdom faces an extraordinary series of assaults in the new front in the Iran war.

A missile struck a passenger terminal and many people were wounded, one of the officials said. They spoke on condition of anonymity because they weren't authorised to speak to the media. Ambulances were seen rushing toward the airport.

Flights to Riyadh diverted elsewhere, the *Flightradar24* tracker said, almost four hours after the last flight landed at 2.05 pm Kuwait Airways said it was cancelling flights because the airport had closed. Canada's embassy advised citizens to avoid all travel to the airport, noting "ongoing military activity."

King Khalid International Airport has been targeted multiple times in the week since a Saudi-led coalition launched a major military offensive against Iran-backed Houthi rebels in neighbouring Yemen. The Houthis claimed responsibility for the earlier attacks, including one Wednesday that killed a Sudanese national.

There was no immediate Houthi statement on Saturday. The Saudi government-run Centre for International Communication, which oversees foreign media in the kingdom, didn't immediately respond to a request for comment.

A Riyadh resident, Ahmed Sayed, told *The Associated Press* he heard at least two loud explosions that rocked the capital.

The airport issued a terse alert telling passengers to check their flight status with airlines before heading to the airport. At least 225 flights at the airport had been cancelled over the past 24 hours, according to flight-tracking site FlightAware.

Fighting in Yemen between the Houthis and Saudi-backed Yemeni government forces has escalated, with the Saudi-led coalition providing air support for Government forces in an attempt to reverse recent Houthi gains along the Red Sea.

The rebels' gains gave them better surveillance of shipping on a corridor that's a crucial alternative to the Strait of Hormuz, where Iran has been attacking ships. Though the Houthis have told the AP and others they are only targeting Saudi shipping as part of a blockade in retaliation for one imposed on them, concerns about wider attacks persist. The Houthis previously attacked other ships after the war in Gaza began, calling it solidarity with Palestinians. A US bombing campaign ended that.

The Saudis have sought support from the US and other allies as its airports, military facilities and oil infrastructure have come under attack. Officials said US assistance has included intelligence sharing, target identification and planning for the latest offensive.

On Friday, as he left the White House, US President Donald Trump was asked about the attacks on the Riyadh airport and told reporters, "It's not good" and "I'm not happy." But there has been no immediate sign of US military support to respond to the attacks.

The Saudi and Omani foreign ministers spoke by phone about the importance of "supporting diplomatic solutions to de-escalate tensions" in the region, the kingdom said Saturday. Oman, which lies across the Strait of Hormuz from Iran, has played a mediator role at times in the region. Meanwhile, Saudi authorities warned the public this week that "filming, publishing or sharing information related to countering missiles and drones and their impact sites exposes you to legal liability."

This week, the Houthis warned global airlines "for the last time" about the potential consequences of operating in Saudi airspace, which they described as a theatre for their military operations.

Air India, FlyDubai, Lufthansa Group and Pakistan International Airlines have been among the airlines suspending flights to and from Riyadh and other Saudi airports for the next few days.

The European Union Aviation Safety Agency has expanded its guidance on Saudi airspace, noting the Houthis' ability to strike targets deeper inside the kingdom, including Riyadh, and a "greater focus on aviation infrastructure."

The missile and drone attacks and interception efforts "create an increased risk of misidentification of civil aircraft," it said.

In Thursday's attack, the Saudi national carrier said one of its aircraft was damaged while it was on the ground, with no passengers on board. (*AP*)

Gagan Thapa elected President of Nepali Congress



SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu

Newly elected Nepali Congress president Gagan Kumar Thapa on Saturday vowed to pursue a policy of "zero tolerance" against corruption and irregularities as he pledged to restore public trust in the party following the 2025 Gen Z protests.

In his first address after being elected president of Nepal's largest political party, Thapa said the new leadership would focus on good governance, transparency and accountability and would not protect anyone involved in corruption or wrongdoing.

Thapa, 50, was elected president of the Nepali Congress at its 15th general convention on Friday, securing 6,584 votes against his rival Shyam Krishna Khadgi's 375 votes.

Addressing party leaders, cadres and the media at the Nepali Congress central office in Sanepa, Lalitpur, Thapa said his priority would be to regain people's trust and restore the party's image, which was tarnished during the 2025 Gen Z movement.

"The party will not protect those who are involved in corruption and irregularity in any way," he asserted.

Thapa said it was now his responsibility to make the Nepali Congress united, strong and dynamic and bring the organisation closer to the people. (*PTI*)

UN speech: India slams Pak over nuclear threats

YOSHITA SINGH ■ United Nations



Anmol Sher Singh Bedi

India hits out at Pakistan at the UN, saying nuclear weapons must not be treated as "routine instruments of statecraft", asserting that New Delhi will "not bow" to nuclear blackmail.

India exercised its Right of Reply at the plenary meeting of the First Committee of the UN General Assembly that deals with Disarmament and International Security issues. Delivering India's Right of Reply, after remarks made by Pakistan raked the issue of Jammu and Kashmir, Senior Adviser (Disarmament) at the Permanent Mission of India to the Conference on Disarmament, Geneva, Anmol Sher Singh Bedi said Jammu and Kashmir is an integral and inalienable part of India. "We call for India's illegally occupied territories to be vacated and returned," he said adding that India does not seek conflict. "India has always stood for peace and continues to seek peace with one and with all. However, if there is no accountability for reckless actions, then peace rarely becomes a pause between crises," he said.

He underlined that India's capabilities are defensive in nature and are shaped by the country's own security environment and are not directed against any state. "We heard concerns about escalation. These are legitimate concerns.

However, these are best judged by conduct over time. Nuclear weapons must not be treated as routine instruments of statecraft," he said.

"A posture that relies on nuclear overhang to limit the consequences of subconventional activity raises the risk of escalation and not the prospect of restraint," Bedi said. Referring to Pakistan's tactics, he said that in India's experience, crises in the region have tended to follow a "recurring pattern: first, provocation; second, denial of responsibility; and third, appeals for restraint once a response has been made.

"Where those in power are neither elected by people nor accountable to them, their decisions carry no risk and impose no cost for those who take them. That is how crisis becomes an instrument of power. (*PTI*)

India, Africa deserve global representation: Jaishankar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Addis Ababa



Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar addresses a gathering at the Adwa Victory Memorial Museum in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia PTI

India and Africa cannot remain underrepresented in global decision-making, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has said, calling for reform of the UN Security Council to make global governance more democratic and representative.

Addressing a gathering at the Adwa Victory Memorial Museum in Addis Ababa , he said the existing global order disregarded the interests of both sides and accused unnamed forces of delaying reform "The current Council neither delivers effectively nor represents fairly. And the two shortcomings are clearly interconnected," Jaishankar said, calling for Africa to be represented fairly in United Nations Security Council membership.

Jaishankar arrived in Ethiopia from Cote d'Ivoire on the final leg of his three-nation African tour, which also included Ghana. Calling for a more representative international order, Jaishankar cited India's efforts during its 2023 G20 presidency to secure permanent membership for the African Union and called for fair African representation in both categories of UN Security Council membership. The UN Security Council has 15 members, including five permanent members — China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom and the United States — which hold veto powers, allowing any one of them to block a substantive resolution.

Jaishankar said India was Africa's fourth-largest trading partner, with bilateral trade nearing $100 billion. More than 220 Indian-supported development projects worth approximately $4.5 billion had been completed across the continent, he said, adding that "development is best served by self-reliance".

Jaishankar said Ethiopia's victory over Italy at Adwa had inspired struggles against colonialism and racial domination across Africa and beyond.

Green card applications from Indian IT firms on decline



SAGAR KULKARNI ■ Washington

Indian IT companies facing suspension from the US permanent labour certification programme have made fewer applications for green cards this year, indicating that the action may not have a significant impact on their functioning.The US on Thursday suspended eight IT firms, including Indian tech giants Tata, Infosys, Wipro and HCL, from a programme to apply for green cards for foreign workers, contending that the practice has shut out Americans from the job market. The other companies were Capgemini, Cognizant, Microsoft and Adobe, which hire a significant number of professionals from India.

An analysis of Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) applications shows that Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) filed just two applications in the US financial year 2026, down from 513 in 2025 and 1,804 in 2024, while HCL filed 59 PERM filings in 2026, down from 323 in 2025.

Wipro filed 257 applications in 2024 and 523 in 2025. Of the 257 applications filed by Wipro in 2024, 169 were denied, and 88 were withdrawn by the company. Infosys filed 87 PERM applications in 2024.

The application data for 2025 and 2026 were not available. "Indian IT companies accounted for less than 1,400 of the 117,849 PERM certifications last year.

Less than two per cent. The direct impact may therefore be smaller than it first appears," Vineet Nayar, former CEO of HCL Technologies, said in a post on X.

Capgemini made 98 PERM applications in 2026, compared with 361 in 2025 and 300 in 2024, according to the website PERM Tracker. (*PTI*)

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Follow us on @SCRailwayindia
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

Tender No. C_SG_36_623 Dt: 07/10/2026 PUB/704

On behalf of the President of India, Sr.Divisionl Signal & Telecom Engineer, Secunderabad Division, South Central Railway, Secunderabad invites open tenders for the following works through E-procurement of the Tenders

S.No.: 01 **Tender No. & Date:** C_SG_36_623 Dt:07/10/2026 Closing dt: 28/10/2026 **Name of the work:** 1. KZJ-BPQ section: Telecom Proposal for Upgradation of Passenger amenities at Odela Railway Station as per NSG-4 category norms (Provision of IPIS as per RDSO/SPN/TC/108/2019 (Ver.-2) or latest and Telecom facilities at Odela Station). 7) S&T proposal ofr Raising of Platform from Medium level to High level PF at RECH in Sr.DEN/North juridiction. SW-II-Proposed extension of existing 3.0m wode FOB from island platform -2/3 to other side of station (NH) at RECH in Sr.DEN/North Juridiction. (TOTAL SEVEN WORKS) . **Approx Advertised Value (₹):** 1,74,54,039.03/- **Bid security/EMD (₹):** 3,49,100/-

For further details visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in.**

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/Co-ord/ Secunderabad

E-Tender Notice No.C-SG-PT-Towers-02 dated 08.10.2026 PUB/705

DyCSTE/Projects/Tele/SC acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders for the following work.

Tender Number and Date: C-SG-PT-Towers-02 dated 08.10.2026 **Name of work :** Ground Infrastructure Works for Provision of Kavach in Purna (Excl.) - Akola section of Nanded Division of South Central Railway. **Estimated Project Cost (₹):** 12,30,67,451.33Ps. **Bid Security (₹):** 24,61,400.00Ps. **Completion Period of Work:** 12 Months **Bid Closing Date (Bid Due Date):** 09.11.2026 at 11.00 hrs **Bid Opening Date:** 09.11.2026 after 11.00 hrs **Validity of Offer:** 120 Days from Bid Closing Date **Cost of Tender Booklet (₹):** 0/-

All bidding is in Indian Railway e-tendring portal **www.ireps.gov.in**. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender. Further details ca be seen in **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom. Engineer/Projects/Tele/ Secunderabad

TENDER NOTICE NO: 26/2026 Dt.09.10.2026. SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS e-Procurement Tender Notice PUB/706

The Following Tenders Have Been Floated Online. Tenders Are Requested To Visit The Website **www.ireps.gov.in** And Submit Their Offers Online. The Tender Description, Qty, EMD, SD May Be Seen In Website. Offers Manually Will Not Accepted. Offers By Post Will Not Be Entertained. Tender Closing Time Is 14.30 Hrs Of The Tender. "For All Indigenous Offers, EMD Will Be Accepted Only Via Online System As Available On **www.ireps.gov.in**."

Tender No.	Brief Description
79261853	Pillow for 2nd & 3rd AC coaches
30261193	Hanger for bolster spring suspension
30263444	Rubber buffer spring sets
33261511A	Earthing cable complete
56261239	Semi-assembled 143mm point machine
29261003A	Loco side buffer assembly high capacity and long life
29265020	Set of electronics cards for E-70 brake system
56261241	Point motors for electric point machine
56265340	110V DC motor for electric point machine (IRS type)
66267776	Track machine spares of plasser make
42251003A	18/20W LED tube light
45265007	VRLA battery 110V, 70 AH
45261037A	Contactor for net 1 & 2, rated voltage : 1000 V AC
LU265563A	Supply, installation, testing & commissioning of X-RAY baggage/ parcel scanners with operating computer, label printers, portable hydraulic scissor table platform and fixed ball deck rollers
40261006	Electronic beam flexible cable
82255019C	Advanced apheresis system

Note:-Due dates of Tender Opening: SL.No.01 on dt.20.10.2026. SL.No.02 & 03 on dt. 21.10.2026 SL No. 04 on dt.22.10.26 SL No.05 & 06 on dt.23.10.26 SL.No.07 to 13 on dt.26.10.2026 SL.No. 14 & 15 dt. 2.11.2026 SL No.16 on dt.5.11.26

Beside Above Mentioned Tenders There Are Other Tenders Having Value Above **Rs.50 Lakhs.**

For Details, Please Visit Railway Website.

Principal Chief Materials Manager/Secunderabad
A816

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at https://www.ireps.gov.in or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

Archbridge Capital Private Limited
Address: DCG-4, 1011-1018, 74A, DLF Corporate Greens, Sector 74A, Southern Peripheral Road, Gurugram, Haryana,122004-India, CIN: U64990HR2024PTC123760

PUBLIC NOTICE
Change in Shareholding of Archbridge Capital Private Limited

Notice is hereby given under Paragraphs 8 to 10 of the **Reserve Bank of India (Non-Banking Financial Companies-Acquisition of Shareholding or Control) Directions, 2025 that Archbridge Capital Private Limited** (CIN: U64990HR2024PTC123760), an NBFC registered with the Reserve Bank of India (CoR No. N-14.03647), having its registered office at DCG-4, 1011-1018, DLF Corporate Greens, Sector 74A, Southern Peripheral Road, Narsinghpur, Gurugram, Haryana 122004 ("the Company"), intends to change its shareholding, as approved by the Reserve Bank of India vide letter no. **DEL.DOR.NBFCBL.No. 883/24-03-044/2026-2027 dated 6th October 2026,** by conversion of redeemable preference shares of ₹ 23.51 crore into ₹ 2,35,10,000 equity shares of ₹10 each, at the request of their holders.

Post conversion, the paid-up equity capital will increase from ₹ 27.00 crore to ₹ 51.50 crore and the shareholding will be as follows:

S. No.	Name of Shareholder	Post-issue %	S. No.	Name of Shareholder	Post-issue %
1.	Mr. Ashish Tewari*	15.53%	18.	Mrs. Rashmi Bansal	2.43%
2.	Mr. Chander Parkash Bhardwaj*	25.24%	19.	Mr. Narender Kumar Bhardwaj	0.99%
3.	Mr. Vikas Bansal*	7.77%	20.	Mr. Surender Kumar Bhardwaj	2.23%
4.	Mr. Praveen Choudhary	0.78%	21.	Mr. Rajesh Kumar Bhardwaj	1.94%
5.	Mr. Aditya Pratap Singh Parmar	1.94%	22.	Mr. Himanshu Bhardwaj	0.68%
6.	Mrs. Maneesha Gupta	5.83%	23.	Mr. Aditya Bhardwaj	0.97%
7.	Mr. Sahil Goyal	0.87%	24.	Mr. Anmol Bhardwaj	1.46%
8.	Mr. Sumit Mittal	0.58%	25.	Mr. Vipin Verma	9.71%
9.	Mr. Harendra Sendhav	0.08%	26.	Mr. Jagdeep Kaushik	0.49%
10.	Mr. Chandraprakash Basant Harlalka	1.94%	27.	Mr. Maneesh Chaturvedi	1.70%
11.	Mrs. Deepika C. Harlalka	1.94%	28.	Mrs. Surabhi Chaturvedi	1.70%
12.	Mr. Deepak Basant Harlalka	1.94%	29.	Mrs. Nidhi Agarwal	0.49%
13.	Mrs. Hansa Deepak Harlalka	1.94%	30.	Mrs. Nisha Kaushik	0.49%
14.	Mr. Deepesh Bansal	1.94%	31.	Mrs. Vijay Srivastava	0.49%
15.	Mrs. Ashima Bansal	1.94%	32.	Mr. Ganesh Ramanand Rao	0.39%
16.	Mr. Prem Chand Bansal	1.94%	33.	Mr. Vikrant Bhagwat	0.19%
17.	Mrs. Renu Bansal	1.46%		Total	100.00%

* Promoter-directors

Objections, if any, may be sent in writing with supporting documents to the Company at its registered office within **30 (thirty) days** of publication of this notice. No objection will be entertained thereafter.

Issued by the Company and jointly by the proposed allottees, who have authorised the Company to publish this notice on their behalf.

For Archbridge Capital Private Limited
Sd/- Ashish Tewari,
Managing Director & CEO (DIN: 02812549)

Place: Gurugram
Date : 11.10.2026

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY
VISAKHAPATNAM
Follow us on @SCoRailway
Website: scor.indianrailways.gov.in

Tender Notice No.05/2026, Dt.09.10.2026
Supply of Stores Items, E-Procurement Tender Notice PUB/SCoR-393

The Following Tenders Have Been Floated Online. Tenders Are Requested To Visit The Website www.Ireps.Gov.In And Submit Their Offers Online. The Tender Description, Qty, EMD, SD May Be Seen In Website. Offers Manually Will Not Accepted. Offers By Post Will Not Be Entertained. Tender Closing is 14.30 Hrs Of the Tender "For All Indigenous Offers, EMD Will Be Accepted Only Via Online System as Available On www.Ireps.Gov.In."

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty	Due Date
1	6026PT005	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of Welding Portion for 60 Kg R-260	93227 Nos	09.11.2026
2	6026PT021	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of WCMS Xing 1in 8.5; 60 kg T-9843-25T	76 SET	09.11.2026
3	6026PT014	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of Thick Web Switch 1 in 8.5 60 Kg-T-9842-25T	191 SET	10.11.2026
4	6026PT018	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of WCMS Xing 1in 8.5; 60 kg T-9776-22.9T	173 SET	11.11.2026
5	6026PT010	Price agreement för manufacture and supply of Thick Web Switch 1 in 12 60 Kg T-9791-25T	415 SET	12.11.2026
6	6026PT017	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of WCMS Xing 1in 12; 60 kg T-9792-25T	454 SET	12.11.2026
7	6026PT025	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of RH/LH Derailing switches 60 kg T-6068	570 SET	16.11.2026
8	6026PT015	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of Thick Web Switch 1 in 16 60 Kg T-10242-22.9T	19 SET	16.11.2026
9	6026PT034	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of HVN Liner 60 kg T-3706	1846524 Nos	23.11.2026
10	6026PT024	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of HVN Liner (Comb. 60kg/52 kg) T-3707 & T-3708	314559 Set	25.11.2026
11	6026PT008	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of Metal Liner 60 kg for Wider Sleepers T-8748	631099 Nos	26.11.2026
12	6026PT033	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of HVN Liner 60 kg for Wider Sleepers T-8751	3800814 Nos	30.11.2026
13	6026PT016	Price agreement for manufacture and supply of Thick Web Switch 1 in 16 60 Kg T-10071-25T	12 SET	03.12.2026

Corrigendum

1) Tender Notice No.04/2026 dt. 29.09.2026 Tender No.6026PT019 corrigendum issued due to change of UVAM Item Reference and modification of special conditions document. 2) Tender No.6026PT005, corrigendum Issued due to change of special conditions document.

Beside Above Mentioned Tenders There Are Other Tenders Having Value Above Rs. 50 Lakhs for details Please Visit Railway Website.

SCoR-A434 **Principal Chief Materials Manager/Visakhapatnam**

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Ajay Sethia, S/o Manik Chand Sethia, R/o F-5/6, 3rd Floor, Model Town-II, North West Delhi, Delhi – 110009, hereby declare that my name and my father's name have been incorrectly mentioned as Ajay Kumar Sethia and Manik Chandra Sethia, respectively, in my Passport. The correct names are Ajay Sethia and Manik Chand Sethia, respectively. This notice is being published for general information and for all future and official purposes and for correction of the aforesaid discrepancies in my passport.

PUBLIC NOTICE (INVITATION TO TENDER)

Human Kind Foundation, Haryana, invites sealed tenders from reputed firms/ suppliers for the following project at Banpur NAC, District Khordha, Odisha

1. Name of Project: Supply and delivery of cleaning equipment at Banpur NAC, District Khordha, Odisha.
2. Tender Submission Start Date: 11 October 2026
3. Last Date for Tender Submission: 17 October 2026
4. Tender Opening Date: 18 October 2026
Tender Details
The detailed scope of work, terms and conditions, and BoQ (Bill of Quantities) are available in the official Notice Inviting Tender (NIT).Interested bidders may scan the QR code or access the link provided below to download all the relevant tender documents.
Contact Details:
Human Kind Foundation
5NH 87, Near Banke Bihari Temple, NIT, Faridabad, Haryana– 121001
Mobile: 9873661681
Link: https://tinyurl.com/hkfbpcl

Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahr Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahr

No. 10181/96M/E-Tender/BSR CIRCLE/2026-27 Dated. 06.10.2026

E-Procurement Short Term Inviting Tender

On behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh, Superintending Engineer Bulandshahr Circle, U.P.P.W.D., Bulandshahr invites following percentage rate Short term bid online through http://etender.up.nic.in from the eligible and approved Contractors registered with P.W.D. class as per column no. 10 below Bridge Work Category as applied from Date 15.10.2026 to 22.10.2026 upto 12:00 Noon as per the prescribed T-2 of Govt. of U.P. The technical bids will be opened online on dated 22.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M. If the office happens to be closed on the date of opening of the bids as specified, the bids will be opened online on the next working day, at the same time any validity of bid will be considered from the original date. The date and time of opening of the financial bid shall be notified on the website.

S. N.	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs.)	Bid Security (Rs. In Lakhs)	Time of Completion work including rainy season	Tender document fee including G.S.T. (In Rs.)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1.	Reconstruction of a minor bridge with a 1×7.00-meter span at km 3 of B.A. Road to Navinagar link road in District Bulandshahr.	64.95	5.25	06 Months Month	Tender Cost Rs 300+ 2000+ 18% G.S.T. Rs. 414.0 = 2714.00	Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Superintending Engineer Bulandshahar Circle, P.W.D., Bulandshahar	Chief Engineer Meerut Zone, P.W.D., Meerut	A, B (Bridge Work)

1. Time allowed for completion of Whole work is mention in col. No. 5 with including rainy season.
2. The Tender Document fee must be deposited through Internet Banking only.
3. The Bidder should have same nature of work experience at least two years.
4. All registered contractors have to upload Turnover certified by C.A. of last 5 years and details of maximum cost of work satisfactorily completed in last 5 years on Chanakya Software before submission of tender.
   Details of e-tender uploaded on http://etender.up.nic.in shall also be uploaded on UP PWD Chanakya software, before last date & time of submission of bid.
5. Terms & other conditions related to bid are available on http://etender.up.nic.in
6. During execution of work contractor should ensure the all safety Measures for COVID-19 issued by the Uttar Pradesh government.
7. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software URL for Prahari is http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahari/.

Executive Engineer
P.D., PWD.
Bulandshahar

(Maneesh Verma)
Superintending Engineer
Bulandshahar Circle, PWD.
Bulandshahar

UP= 257838 Dt. 09.10.26
विज्ञापन वेबसाइट www.upgov.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है

BRIEFLY

Portugal suspends Ronaldo and initiates disciplinary proceedings



The Portuguese soccer federation has suspended Cristiano Ronaldo and initiated disciplinary proceedings against the player for walking out on the team. The federation said in a statement Saturday that the case has been referred to its disciplinary investigation committee and that its findings will remain confidential until its findings are determined.

The 41-year-old Ronaldo left the Portugal team camp during the international window in a dispute with new coach Jorge Jesus over a lack of playing time.

In the games Ronaldo was either an unused substitute or absent, Portugal won all three and his replacement Goncalo Ramos seized his chance by scoring three times.

Ronaldo ended the international break with a long post to his 679 million followers on Instagram, where he asked head coach Jorge Jesus to acknowledge a mistake in asking him to warm up on the sidelines and then not send them on the field against Norway. The Portugal coach did not acknowledge any mistake.

Ronaldo wrote that he expected a suspension under federation rules but promised his fans "we will have one or more farewell matches." (*AP*)

New Zealand pacer O'Rourke ruled out of India series



New Zealand pace bowler Will O'Rourke is the latest casualty ahead of the upcoming tour of India, with the 25-year-old set to miss the series as a precaution while continuing his rehabilitation from injuries to his left hamstring and calf.

The multi-format pacer returned to international cricket earlier this year after a back stress fracture kept him sidelined for seven months. However, he suffered a hamstring tear on the final day of the third Test against England before straining his calf during training in late August. New Zealand coach Rob Walter said the decision to keep O'Rourke out of the India series was taken in consultation with the player and the medical team, with the focus firmly on the team's four-Test tour of Australia in December. New Zealand are scheduled to play five T20Is, five ODIs and two Tests against India, with the series opening with a T20I in Christchurch on October 22.

"It's obviously disappointing for Will to have to miss such a marquee tour at home against India," said Walter. (*PTI*)

Vaibhav in his prime, should play many matches: Sehwag



Former India opener Virender Sehwag traced his famed daredevilry in Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's batting, and said the teen phenom should focus on stitching a long career for the country. Sehwag, owner of 17253 international runs, stands way ahead of the 15-year-old who has scored 246 runs from eight T20Is but at a blistering strike-rate of 186.

"Sooryavanshi is in his prime, and his thinking is somewhat similar to mine, that of hitting right from the first ball. Now, it is about when he gets the opportunity and how many matches he plays for India," Sehwag said during a discussion at the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry's annual session here on Saturday.

The 47-year-old said age should not be a matter of concern if a player is good enough to handle top-flight cricket. "Look, if you are playing in an age-category, it makes sense - if it's Under-19, your age should be under 19. But once you play the IPL or play for India, age doesn't matter.

"A 38-or 40-year-old (Virat) Kohli is playing, and a 15-year-old (Vaibhav) Sooryavanshi is also playing. Then, performance matters," Sehwag said.

The 2011 World Cup winner also lauded India captain Shubman Gill for his second career double hundred in ODIs.

Gill struck a 223 off 133 balls against the West Indies in the second one-dayer at Guwahati on September 30. (*PTI*)

India, WI brace for another run fest in 3rd T20I

DEVARCHIT VARMA
Indore



Another bat versus bat contest is likely to exert further pressure on the bowlers who have taken enough battering already, when India and West Indies face off in the third T20 International at the Holkar Stadium's batting haven here on Sunday.

As many as 501 runs were scored in the second T20I in Ranchi with the West Indies scaling down India's massive 250-run target with more than an over to spare, prompting head coach Gautam Gambhir to throw the spotlight on the plight of bowlers for a second time in the fortnight.

But Gambhir's think tank and his bowlers, along with their peers in the opposition camp, cannot expect any immediate respite especially here in Indore, as the venue traditionally favours the batters with its flat decks and short boundary limits.

It would all thus boil down on execution across departments between the two opponents, with dropped catches and missed opportunities carrying greater significance.

Mayank Yadav spilling a regulation catch of Sherfane Rutherford halfway through the West Indies' innings proved decisive in a way as he went on to eventually add a massive 120 runs off 54 balls with skipper Shai Hope.

Rutherford was only on 38 off 18 when Mayank spilled a gobbler at short fine leg, and the Caribbean southpaw eventually finished at 84 off 37 balls, hammering seven sixes and as many fours. India will also be wary of Hope's form at the top of the order as the West Indies captain has peeled off two centuries on this visit, displaying incredible form and skills to keep his team in contention against the home side's batting might in their backyard.

For India, it would be another excellent test of finding solutions and execution with the ball, with dew also expected to play its part. Batting first, India seemed to have put enough runs on board in Ranchi making 249 for 5, and Mayank's early inroads put them in the driver's seat. But the West Indies, unfazed by early blows, kept hitting back in perfect batting conditions to register their highest-ever run chase. Among the bright spots for India in this series has been skipper Shreyas Iyer rediscovering his mojo after a short session with former batting coach Abhishek Nayar before departing for this series.

With 102 not out and an 18-ball 40, Iyer has found his rhythm as well as solutions to key issues such as generating force with the bat and dominating bowlers, which he felt had slipped away.

Sanju Samson's 41-ball 82 to snap his ordinary run with the bat may keep Vaibhav Sooryavanshi out of the mix, as Gambhir once again reiterated the importance of flexibility in the middle-order but not at the top after the game in Ranchi.

The head coach also admitted that India will continue to experiment with their combinations after Shivam Dube walked out at No. 4 ahead of Iyer. Even though Dube fell only for seven, India are not expected to read much into it.

But India would certainly want more from their ace bowler, Arshdeep Singh, who has given away 79 runs in two matches for only one wicket in return. Mayank cranked up express pace to take two wickets upfront and three overall, and India would want the pace bowler to continue in same manner. (*PTI*)

Gambhir backs Dube's promotion in second T20 against WI

TAPAN MOHANTA
Ranchi



India head coach Gautam Gambhir has defended Shivam Dube's promotion to number 4 position despite the all-rounder's failure to make an impact against the West Indies in second T20 International, reiterating that flexibility in the batting order remains central to the team's approach in the format.

Promoted to Number 4 in place of inform skipper Shreyas Iyer following the departure of Ishan Kishan, Dube laboured to seven off 10 balls before becoming the third victim of West Indies off-spinner Roston Chase in the middle overs.

"We have used him like this for a long time, including during the World Cup and before it. It is not as though this was a one-off decision today," Gambhir said at post-match interaction. Despite Chase's success against left-handed batters, India backed Dube to counter the spin.

In hindsight, India may have missed out on 20-odd runs after losing wickets in successive overs, with top-scorer Sanju Samson also departing soon after.

Iyer and Tilak Varma, however, made up for it and provided the late fireworks to power India to 249 for five despite the loss of momentum in the middle overs. The West Indies then pulled off a record chase, reaching the target in just 18.3 overs to level the five-match series 1-1.

Gambhir stood by the decision to promote Dube, stressing that India would continue to keep their batting order flexible.

"This is international cricket. Sometimes things go your way, and sometimes they don't," he said.

"We lost momentum today, but we have also gained a lot of momentum by sending him in at Number 4, where he has taken on the opposition bowlers," the coach said.

"More importantly, I think we have always been flexible with our batting order, and we will continue to do that. I have always said since taking over that in T20 cricket, only the openers are permanent. The rest of the batting order should remain flexible."

Gambhir refused to attribute India's defeat solely to the difficult bowling conditions, saying the team needed to find ways to defend big totals on flat pitches with dew.

"You don't shrug off any defeat. If you want to keep improving, you don't want to sweep anything under the carpet. We are a world champion team, so we want to keep improving.

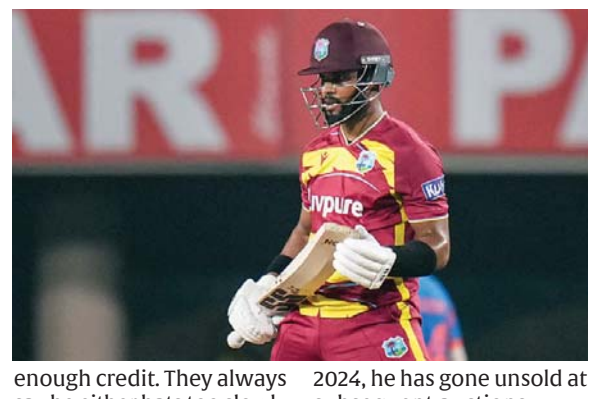
"Obviously, these are tough conditions to bowl in. We know that bowling on flat wickets with dew is difficult, but we need to figure out a way to stop the opposition, especially when they have lost two wickets in the first over and then three in the first six overs," he said.

"Obviously, it was tough, but credit to the West Indies for the way Shai Hope (102 not out) and Sherfane Rutherford (84) batted. We know they are world class batters, especially in this format. It was tough for us, but we are going to keep improving."

While India's spinners struggled to make an impact, Chase's clever variations in line proved effective. However, one of India's major positives was the fiery opening spell from tearaway pacer Mayank Yadav, who consistently clocked speeds above 140 kmph and rattled the West Indies top order. (*PTI*)

People underrate Shai Hope: Roston hails WI skipper after record chase against India

TAPAN MOHANTA
Ranchi



West Indies all-rounder Roston Chase believes their skipper Shai Hope remains an "underrated" cricketer despite his remarkable consistency in white-ball cricket, saying the captain's ability to shut out criticism, remain focused and deliver for his team sets him apart.

With the IPL mini-auction scheduled for December, Hope, who has been ignored by the franchises since his 2024 stint with Delhi Capitals, has strengthened his case with a prolific run across formats, scoring three centuries in his last four innings in ODIs and T20Is.

His latest statement came in Ranchi on Thursday, when he struck his second T20I hundred off just 45 balls to spearhead the West Indies' record chase of 250 against India, sealing a victory with nine balls to spare and levelling the five-match series 1-1.

It was the West Indies' highest successful chase in T20 internationals and the highest successful run-chase against India in the format. Sherfane Rutherford provided the perfect foil with an explosive 86, but it was Hope's commanding innings that anchored the pursuit after the visitors lost two early wickets.

"I think people underrate Shai Hope a lot," Chase said after the victory.

"He is a guy who can block out a lot of noise and focus on what he has to do. I think that is his special skill because, when everything seems to be going wrong, he is still out there giving his best and performing for the team. I think that is his hallmark.

"He is a great player. He probably doesn't have the same record in red-ball cricket, but people also play down his statistics and record, especially in T20 cricket.

"Everyone knows he is great in 50-over cricket, but even then, people sometimes don't give him enough credit. They always say he either bats too slowly or bats for himself.

"I am always happy when I see him do well because I know he is a very professional guy. He puts in the hard work, and he is the ultimate professional. He tries to tick every box and do the right things all the time.

"So, whenever he puts in these performances, I am very happy for him."

Hope's latest exploits carry added significance given the criticism he has faced over his strike rate, particularly in T20 cricket.

Having played just one IPL season, for Delhi Capitals in 2024, he has gone unsold at subsequent auctions.

His strike rate also came under scrutiny during the T20 World Cup, particularly in the virtual quarter-final against India, when he scored 32 off 33 balls at the top of the order as the West Indies posted 195 for four at Eden Gardens in Kolkata. India chased down the target with four balls to spare on their way to winning the title.

Chase also credited Hope's improvement in power-hitting to the hard work, particularly in the gym and during range-hitting sessions. (*PTI*)

Gavaskar questions decision to hold back Mayank at crucial juncture



Sunil Gavaskar and pacer Mayank Yadav FILE PHOTO

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi

Cricket legend Sunil Gavaskar reckons India missed a trick by handing Kuldeep Yadav the crucial 17th over instead of turning to tearaway pacer Mayank Yadav or left-arm quick Arshdeep Singh in the high-scoring second T20I against the West Indies in Ranchi, which the hosts lost by six wickets as the visitors levelled the five-match series 1-1. Kuldeep was taken for 24 runs in a game-changing over, conceding three sixes, a boundary and a wide as the West Indies gained the upper-hand in their daunting chase of 250. The onslaught left India under pressure as the visitors closed in on the target on Friday.

Arshdeep, who bowled the 18th over, could not stem the flow of runs either, conceding 17 to West Indies skipper Shai Hope and Romario Shepherd. The visitors then completed the chase in the 19th over, taking Axar Patel for two sixes to seal comprehensive victory.

"Definitely! I would have gone with either Arshdeep or Mayank (in the 17th over). Yes, Arshdeep went for plenty in his final over (18th over), but Mayank had struck the early blows. Of the wickets that had fallen, he had taken three," Gavaskar told JioStar. "His (Mayank) economy rate was about 12 an over, and at that stage, the West Indies needed more than that. So, if he had taken a wicket, and sometimes when the game is going in your favour, who knows, you would have got a wicket even if it had not been off a great delivery," said Gavaskar.

Mayank still had an over left when the ball was handed to Kuldeep. The tearaway pacer had already dismantled the West Indies top order, dismissing Kamil Pooran (0), Shimron Hetmyer (4) and Rovman Powell (24) to leave the visitors reeling at 58 for three by sixth over.

Gavaskar felt that another strike from Mayank at that crucial juncture could have put the West Indies under immense pressure and made their daunting chase significantly tougher.

"And once you get a wicket, suddenly, the opposition is on the back foot. A new batter has to come in. So, maybe that (bringing in Mayank) could have been tried. For me, I think giving Shivam Dube the ball in that ninth over was not exactly what was required at that stage. When the batters were still trying to get their eye in, maybe Kuldeep coming in would have been a better idea," Gavaskar said pointing out another possible bowling change for criticism.

India spinner Yuzvendra Chahal also raised concerns over the lack of assistance for bowlers on flat pitches, expressing sympathy for the Indian attack. "On such wickets, there's nothing for the bowlers. When the ball gets old, there's dew, the ball comes nicely onto the bat, and the grounds are getting smaller. We've seen this in the IPL as well, with 260 being chased in 19 overs. In this game too, 250 got chased down easily in 18.3 overs," said Chahal.

"So, what should bowlers do? What is the use of their skill? I feel for them, because I am a bowler too and when I bowl in the IPL, on small grounds with flat wickets, you have an Impact Player as well. Earlier, when the Impact Player rule was not there, you used to see 50 runs in six overs, and 170-180 was a fighting total," he said.

"But these days, 70-80 runs are scored in the first six overs, and the game is done there itself. So, either you have to have something for the bowlers in the wicket, or else just install a bowling machine," he added.

IOA elections on December 5, PT Usha calls it milestone for good governance

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi

The Indian Olympic Association (IOA) on Saturday announced that it will elect its new Executive Council on December 5, and kick-started the electoral process by appointing Sanjay Kumar Srivastava as the returning officer to oversee the polls.

Srivastava is a former Election Commissioner of Delhi and Chandigarh. The new Executive Council members will have a tenure of four years (2026-2030).

The IOA said the elections would be held in accordance with the National Sports Governance Act, 2025, the National Sports Governance (National Sports Bodies) Rules, 2026, the amended IOA Constitution, and the applicable IOA Election Bye-Laws and Rules.

"The IOA has appointed Sanjay Kumar Srivastava, IAS (Retd.), former Election Commissioner, Delhi and Chandigarh, as the Electoral Officer/Returning Officer for the 2026 elections. He will conduct, monitor and supervise the elections relating to the Athletes' Commission, Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit (SOMs), and the IOA Executive Council," the IOA said in a statement.

In the 2022 IOA elections, the 77-strong electoral college had the likes of Olympic medallists PV Sindhu, Gagan Narang, Sakshi Malik, Yogeshwar Dutt and MM Somaya. Nearly 25 per cent of the electoral college members were active or former athletes.



Out of the 77, 66 members were from 33 National Sports Federations that nominated one male and one female each, eight SOMs (four male and four female), two from the Athletes Commission (one male and one female) and a member of International Olympic Committee (IOC) in India, Nita Ambani.

The then IOA electoral college had more women members (39) than males (38).

On September 8, the IOA brought its constitution in line with the National Sports Governance Act (NSGA) — except in case of one provision — at its Special General Body Meeting, paving the way for its polls to elect a new Executive Council.

A couple of days later, the Sports Ministry allowed the national Olympic body to continue having a 16-member Executive Council after the IOC recommended that the number remain unchanged despite the NSGA's requirement to limit the panel to 15. The polls for the IOA Athletes' Commission will precede the election of the new Executive Council members, and will be held on November 3. "The Electoral Officer has formally notified the election of the IOA Athletes' Commission for the 2026-2030 term, with polling, counting and declaration of results scheduled for 3 November 2026. Eligible NSF Members are required to nominate two athlete representatives through their duly constituted Athletes' Commissions, with nominations due by 2:00 PM on 11 October 2026," the IOA said.

"Eligible NSF Members are required to nominate two athlete representatives through their duly constituted Athletes' Commissions, with nominations due by 2:00 PM on 11 October 2026.

"The Commission will comprise 10 elected athletes - five men and five women, with the Rules providing for specific representation of Olympic-category athletes and athletes with achievements at major competitions," the IOA said. Two members — one male and one female — of the Athletes' Commission shall be made members of the Executive Council.

Out of the 10 elected members of the IOA Athletes' Commission, six — three male and three female — should have, at the time of election, participated in at least one of the last three editions of the Olympic Games.

The remaining four elected members — two male and two female — should have, at the time of their election, won at least one medal in any of the last three editions of the Asian Games, Commonwealth Games, World Championship/Cup or of the National Games. (*PTI*)

Sunday Pioneer
NEW DELHI | SUNDAY | OCTOBER 11, 2026



The city welcomes Durga

UPROOTED FAMILIES LEFT HOME ACROSS THE BORDER BUT CARRIED THEIR GODDESS ALONG, AND IN CR PARK'S CLAY SHEDS, MAA IS BEING MADE AGAIN

PHOTOS:PANKAJ KUMAR

SAKSHI PRIYA

When the first Bengali families uprooted by Partition settled on a bare stretch of South Delhi in the 1960s, in what was then the East Pakistan Displaced Persons Colony, they carried little besides their language, their love of fish and Maa Durga. The colony, later renamed Chittaranjan Park after the freedom fighter Chittaranjan Das, is now where half of Delhi heads once the dhak starts beating.

A pre-Pujo heritage walk by Sabhyata Foundation traced that story past the Kali Mandir and Market No. 1, where "bhalo achho?" comes before any haggling over fish and the evening adda over tea holds the neighbourhood together. The walk, said Avantika Dalmia, co-chairperson of the foundation's advisory board, "brings together history, memory, craftsmanship and culture", and the best of it came in the lanes where the kumors, the idol makers, were at work.

Every thakur, or idol, begins as a bamboo frame bound with straw, covered with a sticky clay called entel mati and then a finer, sandy bele mati that gives it skin. Faces come from moulds, hands are shaped separately, and each crack the sun opens is filled and wiped again, so an older artisan coaxed a Ganesha's fingers out of wet clay while a young man ran a damp rag over Kartik's chest, both working with the quiet patience of men who know Maa cannot be rushed. Nearby, an artisan in glasses drew a goddess's curved brows with one careful stroke.

Then came Ma, her face the colour of fresh turmeric, her potol-chera chokh, long as a parwal sliced lengthwise, lined thick with kohl beneath the third eye that makes her Trinayani, a faint smile on her pink lips and a gaze, calm and fierce at once, that seemed to follow every visitor. By custom the eyes are painted last, in the ritual of chokkhu daan, the gift of sight, and only when that gaze is in place is the thakur believed to come alive.

For those who cannot make it to Kolkata this Pujo, CR Park is a little Kolkata, with puchkas, fish cutlets dabbed with kasundi, mishti doi and baked rosogolla between pandals. Come Dashami, the goddesses will return to the water to cries of "Aschhe bochhor abar hobe", a promise to meet again next year, but for now the city welcomes Maa Durga home.



IN CR PARK, ARCHANA JAIN OF O'PAUSE TRAVEL EXPERIENCES TAKES SABHYATA FOUNDATION'S PRE-PUJO WALKERS BACK TO THE PARTITION YEARS, WHEN UPROOTED BENGALI FAMILIES BUILT A NEW HOME AND BROUGHT MAA DURGA WITH THEM

THE WALK


Clay: Rows of raw clay idols drying in the lane


Hands: An artisan shapes a Ganesha's fingers from wet clay

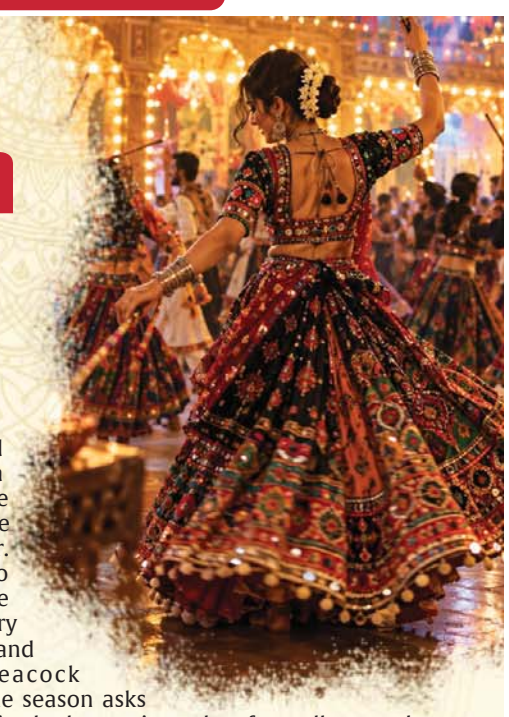

Smoothing: A damp rag smooths fresh cracks before the next layer


Colour: Goddess Lakshmi's owl gets its yellow beak inside the shed


Eyes: A steady brush gives the goddess her eyes

FESTIVE FASHION

From almirah to garba floor



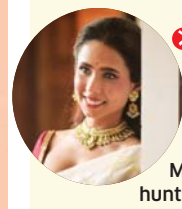
SAKSHI PRIYA

Somewhere in a steel trunk, folded between naphthalene balls and a mother's wedding Banarasi, sits the outfit many young people will wear to the pandal or the garba ground this year. Sharad Navratri runs from October 11 to 19 and Durga Puja falls in the same stretch, and with a colour set for every Navratri night, starting with orange and ending with peacock green, the season asks for nine looks at a time when few college students or first-jobbers can afford nine new chaniya cholis.

So Gen Z, the generation raised on fast fashion, is looking backwards, turning old silk into flared skirts, dressing plain dupattas in gota patti and mirror work, and combing Kolkata's Gariahat and Ahmedabad's Law Garden for the one blouse or pair of jhumkas nobody else will be wearing. The numbers agree with the mood, as Pinterest's Fall 2025 trend report recorded a 127 per cent jump in thrift-related searches from India, with "thrift flips" up 486 per cent, while a Mobility Foresights study expects the country's second-hand clothing market to grow from $5.2 billion in 2025 to nearly $18 billion by 2031.



AS THE FESTIVE SEASON BEGINS, LIFESTYLE CREATOR AND A CELEBRITY DESIGNER SHARE HOW THEY ARE PUTTING THEIR LOOKS TOGETHER



Anusmita Dutta
Entertainment and lifestyle creator

For Anusmita Dutta, Puja dressing begins on foot, between the crowded pavements of Gariahat, New Market and Hatibagan, where she hunts for "that one saree, blouse or piece of jewellery that instantly speaks to me." Skipping trends, she gives traditional pieces "a contemporary, personal spin," letting accessories follow the outfit's mood. During Puja, she says, Kolkata's fashion feels "incredibly democratic," with everyone dressing up, whether shopping at a designer store or a street stall.



IMAGES ARE FOR REPRESENTATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY.



Niti Bothra
Celebrity fashion designer, founder and creative director, Label Niti Bothra

"Some of the best Navratri looks are often already in your wardrobe," says Niti Bothra, who would turn an old silk saree into a flared skirt and dress up a plain dupatta with gota patti or mirror work. "For colour-themed nights, I like starting with a neutral base and changing the dupatta or accessories," she says, adding that hours of garba call for light fabrics.



Inside Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra's traditional revival of SHRI RAM



PHOTOS:PANKAJ KUMAR

TEAM VIVA

As Navratri takes over the city, families and students have a rare chance to understand the authentic cultural history behind Dussehra. From today, audiences can see the epic live under the Mandi House sky.

For its 69th year, Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra's SHRI RAM drops modern screens to resurrect the 1957 vision of stalwarts like Ramdhari Singh Dinkar, Guru Gopinath, and the Dagar Brothers. What audiences will witness is pure physical theatre.

The visual shift is striking. Archers in yellow and green silks hold strict traditional stances with curved wooden bows. Ravana dominates the stage in heavy Kathakali skirts and intense face paint as Surpanakha weeps beside him. The pacing shifts naturally without any digital help. You watch Ram lift the heavy bow and exchange garlands on a hand-carved wooden chariot, before the bright celebrations suddenly drop into the quiet of the forest exile. Here, the royal silks are swapped out for simple ochre cloth, rudraksha beads and fresh white flowers. It all builds to the striking symmetry of the final coronation, anchored by a devoted, kneeling Hanuman. Even backstage, dancers preparing with raw pigments and rich, hand-stitched fabrics ground the entire performance in genuine Indian craftsmanship.

"SHRI RAM is a tradition that has lived across generations. This year, as we return to its traditional form after nearly 25 years, we are reconnecting with the visual language, music and verses that have shaped its identity," notes Padmashri Shobha Deepak Singh.

Watching our history unfold live on stage, the festive season is finally here.



TRADING MODERN SCREENS FOR PURE PHYSICAL THEATRE, A HISTORIC 69-YEAR-OLD PRODUCTION RETURNS TO ITS ORIGINAL 1957 ROOTS. WATCH AUTHENTIC INDIAN CRAFTSMANSHIP AND EPIC STORYTELLING

Actors bring epic characters to life

The grand Luv Kush Ramlila will bring the Ramayana to life at Lal Qila. Devesh Sharma as Ram, Kaveri Priyam as Sita and Raj Premi as Ravan showcased their looks during rehearsal. Devesh said playing Lord Ram was "a matter of faith, responsibility and good fortune". Ravan's imposing 11-kilogram crown adds grandeur to the production. Pankaj Kamad will portray Hanuman in the spectacular staging, which promises elaborate costumes, impressive sets and powerful performances by television and film actors.



Devesh Sharma as Ram and Kaveri Priyam as Sita

Raj Premi as Ravan

PHOTOS:PANKAJ KUMAR

READING CORNER

CORBETT LITERATURE FESTIVAL UNITES NATURE VOICES



GYANESHWAR DAYAL

The inaugural Corbett Literature Festival concluded on October 8 at The Golden Tusk, following three days of conversations on wildlife, rivers, folk music and the future of one of India's best-known wildlife landscapes. Titled "3 Days in the Wild", the festival ran from October 6 to 8 on the banks of the Kosi River, bringing together more than 30 writers, conservationists, historians, photographers and storytellers for over 20 sessions across three venues: The Golden Tusk, The Riverview Retreat and Aahana Resort & Spa. Supported by the Uttarakhand Forest Department, Corbett Tiger Reserve and Uttarakhand Tourism, the programme included masterclasses in wildlife photography and filmmaking, guided nature walks, and cultural evenings celebrating Uttarakhand's music, food and storytelling.

The opening day explored Jim Corbett's legacy, conservation, Garhwali folk music and experiences from the forest frontline. Forest Minister Subodh Uniyal stressed that conservation could not be separated from the welfare of communities living around forests. Principal Secretary RK Sudhanshu said the festival would broaden the way the world viewed Corbett. The second day began with a bird and tree walk, followed by sessions on Himalayan ecology, Pahadi food, wildlife photography and responsible tourism. Speakers emphasised that Corbett's identity extended beyond its tigers, highlighting farmers, pastoralists and tourism businesses dependent on the Kosi and Ramganga watersheds. The final day featured a wildlife photography exhibition at Jungle Grill, curated by Sriroopa Raheja Bajaj, alongside discussions on natural history, rivers and nature writing. Bollywood playback singer Jubin Nautiyal made a special appearance, supporting the festival's focus on wildlife and forest conservation. He praised forest staff for their imagery of Corbett and welcomed the public response, saying he was encouraged to see people standing up for "things that really matter, which will actually matter in the long run". Anirudh Lakhotia, Director of Ivory Destinations, which owns The Golden Tusk, described the festival as deeply personal to his family, whose hospitality journey in Corbett spans decades. He called Corbett "the perfect backdrop for conversations about nature, wildlife, the Himalayas and Uttarakhand's culture". Corbett Tiger Reserve Field Director Saket Badola, whom Chief Wildlife Warden Neena Grewal credited with initiating the festival, said the first edition demonstrated how a literary perspective could offer a fresh view of a destination. Organisers plan to make the festival a recurring platform, with smaller events throughout the year. The three-day event concluded with a gala dinner, live music and live painting.



The Pioneer

AGENDA

New Delhi
October 11, 2026

It is better to lead from behind and to put others in front, especially when you celebrate victory when nice things occur. You take the front line when there is danger.
– Nelson Mandela



MODI MANTRA

MAKE MODERNISE MOTIVATE

On October 7, 2001, Narendra Modi took charge as Gujarat Chief Minister. Twenty-five years later, his uninterrupted leadership spans more than a decade in the state and more than 12 years at the Centre, reshaping India's politics, governance and political discourse

Modi at 25 and the road to 2047



GOURAV VALLABH
Professor of Finance & PT Member – Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister

On October 7, 2026, Narendra Modi marked a quarter-century of executive leadership, a journey that began as Gujarat's Chief Minister in 2001 and continued as India's Prime Minister from 2014. His combined tenure is the longest for a head of government in India. The significance of this milestone lies in what sustained leadership can accomplish: carrying reforms through implementation and building institutions capable of serving a vast democracy. Three electoral victories in Gujarat and three terms as Prime Minister provided the time to pursue this institutional change. That experience now informs India's ambition of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

Gujarat offered an early lesson in how administrative reform could improve everyday life. Jyotigram, launched in 2003, separated agricultural electricity feeders from those serving households and other users. Farmers received a scheduled eight-hour supply, while non-agricultural users received round-the-clock power. Reliable electricity also strengthened services beyond the power sector: a peer-reviewed study published in 2019 found improvements in primary health centres' operating capacity, vaccination and antenatal care. The lesson was clear: solving one infrastructure problem could improve several aspects of development.

That understanding shaped the national emphasis on removing obstacles between citizens and essential services. Financial inclusion became a foundation for this approach. By August 19, 2026, Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana had 59.09 crore accounts, including 32.92 crore held by women. These account numbers indicate the reach of formal banking, enabling direct benefit transfers and access to savings. For households previously dependent on intermediaries, accessible banking can reduce uncertainty and the costs of receiving assistance.

Once banking access expanded, digital payments widened its economic possibilities. UPI recorded approximately 241.62 billion transactions in 2025-26. Shared, interoperable infrastructure allowed banks and competing applications to serve merchants and consumers without each building a separate payments network. Modi's contribution has been to give inclusion and digital delivery sustained political priority, integrating institutional capabilities at population scale. Banks, regulators, technology professionals and state administrations have been indispensable partners in that expansion.

The benefits of reliable systems extend from financial transactions to necessities at home. Jal Jeevan Mission began in August 2019 with 3.23 crore rural households having tap-water connections. States and Union Territories reported 15.89 crore connections by July 18, 2026, covering 82.09 per cent of rural households. This expansion can release time previously spent collecting water. Maintaining water quality and a dependable supply must now consolidate the gains from creating connections. Together with rising incomes and employment, better services contribute to improved living conditions. The World Bank's October 2026 Macro Poverty Outlook estimates that extreme poverty fell from 27 per cent in 2011 to 2.6 per cent in 2023. Since the baseline predates Modi's premiership, the entire decline cannot be attributed to one government. It nevertheless demonstrates the progress that economic growth, state-level action and welfare delivery can collectively achieve.

Sustaining that progress requires an expanding economy capable of financing public services. The Union government's capital expenditure allocation has risen from roughly ₹2 lakh crore in 2014-15 to ₹12.2 lakh crore in 2026-27. These are nominal budget figures, whose effectiveness depends on spending and project quality. Physical capacity has expanded alongside them: the national highway network grew from 91,287 kilometres in March 2014 to 146,572 kilometres by February 2026, connecting businesses with wider markets.

Those connections can make private investment more productive and spread opportunity geographically. Official estimates show real GDP growing by 7.8 per cent in April-June 2026, with real gross fixed capital formation increasing by 11.9 per cent. Although one quarter cannot establish a lasting trend, strong investment supports future capacity. The objective should be to translate infrastructure into competitive enterprises and better employment beyond the largest metropolitan centres.

Manufacturing illustrates how that translation is taking place. Official figures show mobile-phone production rising from ₹18,900 crore in 2014-15 to ₹6.27 lakh crore in 2025-26, with exports reaching ₹2.60 lakh crore in the latter year. This nominal expansion establishes a substantial industrial presence. The opportunity is to deepen it through domestic components, engineering and research, allowing India to retain more value from the products it manufactures.

Industrial depth also strengthens strategic autonomy. Defence exports increased from ₹686 crore in 2013-14 to ₹38,424 crore in 2025-26. Building domestic capabilities can support skilled employment and reduce dependence on external suppliers. Procurement that rewards quality, innovation and timely delivery will ensure that manufacturing growth also strengthens the armed forces.

CONTINUED ON >> PII



The umpire problem: The countdown begins



PAWAN KHERA
Member of parliament, Rajya Sabha, Chairman, Media & Publicity Dept., AICC, Member Congress Working Committee

On October 7, the day Narendra Modi completed 25 years at the head of a government, Delhi Police hauled Priyanka Gandhi and other opposition leaders off the streets of the capital to stop them reaching Jantar Mantar. Roads across New Delhi were sealed. As Rahul Gandhi was bundled into a police bus, Congress workers deflated the tyres of a few police vans and delivered their verdict on the quarter-century: "Modi ki hawa puncture ho rahi hai." Tyres, unlike television anchors, cannot be told what to say.

A government — Modi's government — that claims to be celebrating the people's trust felt it had to unleash the brute force of Delhi Police on citizens, civil society and opposition politicians to protect the referee of the Indian elections from Indian people.

On his anniversary, the Prime Minister thanked voters for choosing him. Voters deserve to know who chose the Chief Election Commissioner. The answer is the Prime Minister, his own minister, and a two-to-one vote held 48 hours before the Supreme Court could step in.

If Modi trusts the people as much as his speech claims, the remedy costs him nothing. Back the CEC's impeachment. Disband the current Commission. Restore the Chief Justice to the appointment panel. Let a neutral committee review the SIR process. Make the Commission publish every objection its own members have filed. Repeal the SIR, restore the voting rights of 13.30 crore citizens disenfranchised illegally through the SIR, dismiss the governments which have been formed on the basis of Vote Chori and go back to elections on ballot paper. A mandate that is manufactured through the choice of a favourable umpire is not a mandate. It is a fixed match.

But Modi cannot afford to do it if he wants to stay in power. So he keeps stealing mandates and governments to create a fake sense of popularity and power. The Prime Minister said that "whether Assembly or Lok Sabha, people have chosen me for their service for 25 years." It is a lovely sentence. Like most lovely sentences in politics, it collapses when you count.

Day one. The clock started on October 7, 2001, when Modi took the oath as Gujarat's Chief Minister. On that day, not one voter had chosen him for anything. He was not even a member of the Assembly. The BJP's central leadership removed Keshubhai Patel and sent Modi to replace him, and he won a by-election only months later. The 25-year mandate begins with a nomination, not an election.

The national record. In 2024, the BJP won 36.56 per cent of the vote. Across three national elections, with all its money and machinery, it has never won a majority of Indian votes. The party that promised "400 paar" got 240. It lost Ayodhya, and its margin shrank in Varanasi. In the South, it barely registers. And where it has grown fastest, in West Bengal, the voter rolls have shrunk fastest: 27 lakh names struck off. The Election Commission still cannot tell the Supreme Court who filed 16 lakh further deletion appeals in its name.

Modi's castle is built on the disenfranchisement and suffering of millions of poor, rural, uneducated and desperate Indians who 'need' the State to restore dignity and well-being to their lives. So clearly, there is nothing about these 25 years that deserves collective celebration. There has been no shortage of allegations. There has been a shortage of investigations.

In 2012, the CAG flagged a ₹5,000 crore loss at GSPC and gas sold below cost to Adani Energy. The report was tabled on the last day of the Assembly session, an excellent day for tabling reports you would rather nobody discussed. PM CARES carries the Prime Minister's name and the public's money. Yet when a student filed an RTI, the PMO replied that it is not a "public authority". Public money, public name, not public. Quite an achievement.

Nearly $2 billion flowed through electoral bonds, over half to the BJP. The Supreme Court unanimously struck the scheme down. The data that followed showed companies under investigation bought bonds worth $223 million after being raided. In economics, that is a correlation. In Hindi, there is a simpler word, and the Court politely did not use it. Abroad, the American regulator charged Gautam Adani over alleged bribes to Indian officials. At home, India's agencies have stayed silent.

So yes, he can say no allegation has touched him. It is a remarkable claim, mainly for how much effort has gone into keeping it true.

Parties that agree on almost nothing have signed the same notice seeking the removal of his Chief Election Commissioner. The Supreme Court is questioning why a Cabinet Minister sits on the panel that selects the umpire, and how certain decisions were taken — and by whom. Allies and frenemies alike are turning up at demonstrations. Public anger against Modi is growing, and Amit Shah's police are abjectly failing to "contain and neutralise" it. The Sangh has hinted at retirement. Modi's days in office are numbered.

But there is one enduring truth about Durbars: they bury the truth and project permanence right up to the moment they collapse. His ministers may have no choice but to applaud and flatter the man who appoints them. But if only they stopped applauding for a moment, Modi might finally hear the countdown. The real pressure points, however, are close: the 2027 Presidential election and Uttar Pradesh.

CONTINUED ON >> PII

10 major decisions taken by Prime Minister Modi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has taken several landmark political and policy decisions that have fundamentally reshaped India's political, economic and constitutional landscape

Abrogation of Article 370 (2019): In a historic constitutional move, the Modi government revoked the special status of Jammu and Kashmir. The region was fully integrated with the Indian Union and bifurcated into two separate Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh.

Implementation of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) (2017): This sweeping economic reform unified national taxation. By replacing a web of complex state and central indirect taxes, it turned India into a single, unified tax market.

Demonetisation (2016): In a sudden announcement, the government invalidated all ₹500 and ₹1,000 currency notes. The decision was aimed at curbing black money, choking terror funding and digitising the economy.

Introduction of the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) (2019): The administration enacted the CAA to grant a fast-track pathway to Indian citizenship for persecuted religious minorities (including Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis and Christians) from Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan.

The Jan Dhan-Aadhaar-Mobile (JAM) Trinity & Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT): The government linked Jan Dhan bank accounts, Aadhaar biometric IDs and mobile numbers. This political-administrative shift allowed welfare subsidies to be transferred directly into the accounts of the poor, eliminating leakages and middlemen.

Ban on Triple Talaq (2019): The government passed legislation criminalising the practice of Talaq-e-Biddat (instant divorce) among Muslims, framing it as a crucial reform for gender justice and the protection of women's rights.

Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (2014): Launched immediately after taking office, this nationwide sanitation campaign transformed cleanliness into a mass movement. The policy successfully funded and constructed millions of household toilets across rural and urban India.

Aatmanirbhar Bharat & Make in India Initiatives: Aimed at boosting self-reliance, the government introduced these frameworks alongside Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes to scale up domestic manufacturing, protect supply chains and reduce import dependency.

Enactment and Repeal of the Three Farm Laws (2020-2021): The government introduced three major agricultural marketing reforms. Following protracted, widespread protests by farmer unions, PM Modi made the tactical political decision to officially repeal the laws.

Agnipath Military Recruitment Scheme (2022): The executive introduced a major structural reform to the armed forces by changing the recruitment model. Under this policy, soldiers (Agniveers) are recruited on a short-term, four-year contract to foster a younger age profile within the military.

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This Week's Zodiac Insights
Profession • Money • Family • Relationships • Health • Travel

Mesha | Aries: The week may begin with hurdles, but your ability to turn situations around grows stronger as the days pass. Business may move slowly, so handle shared money carefully. Family understanding can improve, while a peaceful trip may clear your mind. Keep meals regular if fasting affects digestion.
Watch out for: Careless transactions and stomach sensitivity.

Vrishabha | Taurus: Recognition is possible for creative or public-facing work, even if routine progress feels slower. Rather than forcing momentum, try a fresh approach and keep costly purchases on hold. Family brings reassurance, and a solo trip can be uplifting. In relationships, clarity will prevent small doubts from becoming larger.
Watch out for: Unplanned expenses and stress.

Mithuna | Gemini: A busy week can work to your advantage, especially if you stay focused on priorities. Career prospects strengthen, and delayed business income may begin to improve. Family and friends offer useful support, while a home move or new connection may bring excitement.
Watch out for: Overwork, long screen hours and eye strain.

Karka | Cancer: This is a good week to clear pending matters and let consistent effort speak for you at work. Financial transactions need careful documentation, while compromise can make relationships easier. Business travel may introduce valuable contacts, and family achievements bring pride.
Watch out for: Rushed money decisions, stress and physical fatigue.

Simha | Leo: Progress comes through discernment rather than speed this week. New business partnerships may be worth exploring but take time to assess them properly. Building an additional income source can offer reassurance. Relationship tensions can soften through patience, while a spiritual break may restore perspective.
Watch out for: Sharp words and neglecting family health.

Kanya | Virgo: There is room for measured expansion this week. Business growth and stronger finances can support future plans, but keeping an emergency reserve will add security. Old differences with parents may ease, and a possible house move brings fresh momentum. Relationships benefit from compromise.
Watch out for: Digestive discomfort and insensitive communication.

Tula | Libra: A useful business opening may come through trusted connections, even if career advancement takes longer than hoped. Protect your income, finish pending work early and accept help from siblings when needed. A change of scene can restore energy, while thoughtful words protect relationships.
Watch out for: Burnout, financial pressure and unnecessary arguments.

Vrishchika | Scorpio: Steady business progress can improve confidence, and an earlier loan to a friend may finally return. A vehicle purchase or home move may also come into focus. Give relationships more time than usual and use negotiation rather than pressure in family matters.
Watch out for: Back or abdominal discomfort and emotional neglect.

Dhanu | Sagittarius: Clear thinking and direct communication help you manage a slower business phase. Money owed to you may take longer to return, so plan without depending on immediate repayment. Foreign travel can move forward, and new professional contacts may prove useful. Family may need extra support.
Watch out for: Exhaustion and delayed payments.

Makara | Capricorn: A new initiative may need time to win others over, but support can grow once its value becomes clear. Partnership work looks promising, while investments deserve a conservative approach. Love matters improve, work travel stays active and helpful colleagues may strengthen progress.
Watch out for: Speculative decisions, family stress and breathing discomfort.

Kumbha | Aquarius: A calmer week helps you rebuild confidence and authority at work. Earnings remain comfortable enough to support both present needs and future savings. Family planning becomes steadier, and a visit to a sacred place may bring perspective. Relationships improve when differences are discussed calmly.
Watch out for: Heated exchanges and complacency with spending.

Meena | Pisces: This week rewards patience more than quick decisions. New business agreements may hold promise, but rising expenses call for tighter planning. Family concerns respond better to calm conversation, and an elder may need your presence. Relationships may feel quieter than usual, while unfamiliar travel deserves care.
Watch out for: Impulsive choices and unexpected health expenses.

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ANIL BHAT



SCEPTICISM SURROUNDING CHINESE DIPLOMATIC AGREEMENTS IS HIGHLY JUSTIFIED GIVEN THE HISTORICAL PATTERN OF UNILATERAL ACTIONS ALONG THE LAC

A day after the September 12-13, 2026, BRICS Summit attended by Chinese President Xi Jinping and preceded by the August 25, 2026, Special Representative Talks on the India-China Boundary Question in Beijing, India's Ministry of Defence (MoD) publicly released its 2025-26 Annual Report, stating that the PLA had scaled down its deployments opposite India's northern borders. The timing of this report led to viral social media claims and news summaries inadvertently implying that the troop pullback was an immediate, direct result of the 2026 summit. Soon afterwards, the MoD clarified that this troop reduction took place in 2024 and 2025.

While the India-China eight-point agreement offers mutual security and economic mechanisms, critics are apprehensive about the "early harvest" approach as it primarily suits Beijing's strategic pacing. They argue that it favours China because: (a) it is a shift from a comprehensive package to piecemeal delimitation; (b) it focuses on easier middle/Sikkim sectors first; (c) it leaves the basic western/eastern disputes unresolved; (d) it normalises ties before full 2020 status quo restoration; and (e) it allows China to project a peaceful diplomatic image globally.

The mutual benefits for India are: (a) reduction of immediate military friction along the Line of Actual Control (LAC); (b) adds hotlines to prevent accidental tactical escalation; (c) resumes traditional Kailash-Manasarovar Yatra pilgrimage batches; (d) reopens designated local border trading points; and (e) restores routine diplomatic communication channels. While experts believed that all previous special representative talks have been used by China primarily as a tool for crisis management and narrative diplomacy rather than a medium for a final, permanent border resolution, it remains to be seen if New Delhi can leverage these talks to secure a fair, permanent boundary framework.

Scepticism surrounding Chinese diplomatic agreements is highly justified, given the historical pattern of unilateral actions along the Line of Actual Control (LAC). However, looking closely at the tangible outcomes of the diplomatic process culminating in the 2024 LAC Patrolling Agreement and subsequent bilateral talks in 2025 and 2026, India did secure several specific, measurable operational advantages. Following the 2020 Galwan standoff, the Chinese military blocked Indian troops from reaching long-held Patrolling Points (specifically PPs 10 through 13 in Depsang). The diplomatic breakthrough made a return to the pre-2020 status quo in these sectors, legally and physically reinstating India's access to contested patrolling grounds.

China significantly reduced its frontline military deployment opposite India's northern borders in 2025, cutting troop levels in eastern Ladakh by about half compared with peak crisis numbers, primarily due to high logistical and operational strains. The nature of disengagement in eastern Ladakh vs. Arunachal Pradesh reveals distinct, considered priorities for Beijing. Hence, there has been no reduction in the deployment in Arunachal Pradesh, which China continuously keeps claiming as its own.

In eastern Ladakh, the PLA's reduction of frontline troops from specific friction points (such as Galwan, Pangong Tso, Depsang and Demchok) was not a full retreat. Instead, it was an optimised force reconfiguration driven by geography: the high-altitude desert of Ladakh, with extreme sub-zero temperatures, often dipping below -20°C to -40°C, and scarce oxygen levels, takes a heavy physical toll on operating tank units and infantry and rapidly degrades advanced military hardware. The Indian Army generally displays better operational endurance in extreme high-altitude regions compared with Chinese People's Liberation Army (PLA) troops, largely due to decades of continuous deployment and specialised training.

The key elements of the discussion between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi were reportedly bilateral cooperation, border stability and mutual sensitivities.

On bilateral cooperation, PM Modi welcomed President Xi to India and thanked China for its support during India's BRICS chairmanship, noting that the engagement provided a constructive opportunity to discuss economic and cultural ties.

PM Modi emphasised that future relations should be guided by "mutual respect, mutual interest and mutual sensitivity".

Both leaders acknowledged that maintaining peace along the border areas serves as an essential foundation for normalising and developing broader bilateral ties. They committed to working towards a fair, reasonable and mutually acceptable resolution of the boundary question while observing existing agreements.

The leaders addressed economic and structural trade imbalances, supply chain challenges and the need for predictable market access to foster cooperative growth.

For years, China's official position was that the border dispute should be "set in its proper place" while resuming normal business and trade. India rigidly maintained that normal relations are impossible without border peace. By compelling Xi Jinping to engage in direct bilateral border management reviews at the SCO and BRICS summits, India appears to have, at long last, made China accept border peace and the "three mutuals" — mutual respect, sensitivity and interest — as the fundamental prerequisite for broader ties.

It is critical to distinguish between tactical advantages and strategic trust. Security analysts emphasise that China did not act out of selflessness; Xi's compromises were driven by practical necessities, including a slowing domestic economy, escalating technology trade wars with the US and a desire to stabilise its regional periphery. The current operational reality between India and China is a tactical supply-chain and border stabilisation truce rather than a full strategic reset. On the economic front, India has reportedly made Beijing lift critical trade blockades. Recent diplomatic rounds made China ease export restrictions on vital industrial resources, including rare earths, fertilisers and heavy infrastructure equipment (like tunnel boring machines), which Beijing had previously been holding up as strategic leverage.

On the ground, India must not lower its guard. While physical troop presence has thinned, China continues to build permanent military infrastructure and deploy surveillance technology along the border. India's response has been maintaining a robust, heavily mirrored deployment across all sectors, while using the diplomatic agreements strictly as a mechanism to prevent active conflict while matching China's capabilities on the ground.

New Delhi must maintain a stance of cautious pragmatism towards Beijing and distinguish that, while certain critical trade blockades and export curbs have been lifted, severe structural vulnerabilities and strategic mistrust remain.

Col Anil Bhat, VSM (Retd), is a strategic affairs analyst and former Defence Ministry and Indian Army spokesperson; views presented are personal

FROM AGENDA COVER

Modi at 25 and the road to...

Greater domestic capability, in turn, gives diplomacy stronger foundations. India's 2023 G20 presidency helped secure the African Union's permanent membership through agreement with other members. This demonstrated the practical value of convening power in advancing developing countries' representation. Such influence can help India build partnerships that widen access to technology, investment and markets.

These opportunities sharpen the next development challenge: converting expanded capacity into dependable livelihoods. Better technical education, employer-linked apprenticeships and easier growth for small firms can raise productivity and earnings. Women's financial inclusion must similarly lead to greater opportunities for paid work and enterprise.

Rising productivity will also require progress from Make in India to Design in India. Indian firms need stronger capabilities in technology and intellectual property, supported by testing facilities, competitive research funding and university-industry partnerships. Artificial intelligence should advance the same purpose through skills and applications that improve business efficiency and public services.

Such progress must be supported by institutions that remain effective across electoral cycles. Transparent measurement, independent evaluation and responsive grievance systems can improve implementation. Cooperation with states and meaningful citizen participation will make these achievements more durable.

Viksit Bharat @2047 gives these priorities a common destination: a developed India at the centenary of independence.

Modi's first 25 years have established capabilities on which that ambition can build. The next test is whether a bank account enables enterprise, infrastructure creates productive employment and manufacturing generates Indian innovation. A developed nation will be recognised in the security of its households and the opportunities available to its young people. The most enduring measure of Modi's quarter-century will be how firmly it places that promise within every Indian's reach.

The writer is professor of Finance and PT Member - Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister

The umpire problem...

If the BJP loses UP, powerful voices within the Sangh will push for a change at the top. If Yogi wins a highly unlikely third consecutive term, expect an equally forceful push to end Modi's tenure.

Either way, the Prime Minister can keep flying. He can address another diaspora rally, pose with another President who taxes Indian exports, and collect another honorary award. But all the spectacle in the world cannot conceal the reality of a man who has presided over the destruction of our democracy, fears confronting the magnitude of the damage, and hopes to cling to power with Amit Shah's brute force.

A leader confident of his people does not fear protest. A leader secure in his mandate does not need the police to defend his legitimacy. It is a leader who fears that the people have turned against him who must deploy the entire machinery of the state to silence their dissent.

Modi is no longer celebrating. These are the last few flickers of a candle that mistook itself for the sun.

In other words – "Hawa nikal chuki hai."

The writer is a Member of parliament in Rajya Sabha since June 2026. He is the chairman of the media and publicity wing of the Indian National Congress party

Dancing with Dad: Who will be there after me?



JEEVESH GUPTA | HARISH JAIN



Watching Dancing with Dad at Stein Auditorium, the performance raises a question that shadows many parents' lives: who will care for a child when the parent is no longer here? For the father of an autistic son, that anxiety acquires a particular urgency. It concerns care and security, but also understanding. Who will recognise the person his son is, and make room for the way he experiences the world?

Presented by Maneesh Verma and Collective Madness, the play brings this uncertainty into an intimate encounter between a dancer father, played by Sumeet Nagdev, and his autistic son, portrayed by Arjun Kachroo. The father tries to help his son imagine a life beyond his presence. Yet their exchanges also reveal how much the father himself must learn: about his son's feelings, his responses, and the possibilities of a relationship in which both can speak and be heard.

The performance conveys the sense of a father and son meeting as equals. They inhabit different worlds, but the performance allows us to glimpse the connections between them. The father's apprehension encounters the son's apparent ease; a tremble meets a giggle; fear gives way, briefly, to surprise. These shifts carry the emotional weight of the production. They make the relationship recognisable without pretending that its difficulties can be easily resolved.

Nagdev and Kachroo give these exchanges an affecting immediacy. Their performances draw attention to the effort involved in reaching another person-and to the unexpected moments when that effort becomes mutual. The father seeks to prepare his son for the future, while the son opens up ways of feeling and communicating that the father cannot entirely anticipate.

The production also brings a wider social failure into view. Autistic people continue to encounter misunderstanding, exclusion and the assumption that difference means incapacity. In schools and everyday life, the pressure to conform can leave little room for an individual's own rhythms of learning and expression. Too often, the difficulty others have in understanding someone becomes a judgement about that person's abilities.

Dancing with Dad invites audiences to question that judgement. The son has an emotional life that asks to be recognised on its own terms. He can respond, surprise, learn and teach. The relationship becomes richer when the father allows himself to receive as well as guide.

This gives the father's central anxiety a larger significance. "What will happen after me?" is a question addressed to society as much as to the family. A parent's love cannot, by itself, secure a child's future. That requires schools willing to include, communities willing to understand, and support that does not disappear with the caregiver. The play leaves these questions open, and they follow the audience out of the auditorium.

The performance raises questions about theatre's place in a screen-dominated world. At Stein Auditorium, a private parental fear became a shared experience, reminding audiences of the power of live performance.

Digital media could carry such work to a much wider public. Whether it gives space to this patient engagement, amid the pursuit of clicks and attention, remains an open question.

Dancing with Dad begins a conversation that continues beyond the performance. It deserves an audience, especially among those whose understanding of autism remains distant or uncertain. Its most affecting invitation is also its simplest: to look more closely, listen more patiently, and recognise a person where audiences may previously have seen only a disability.

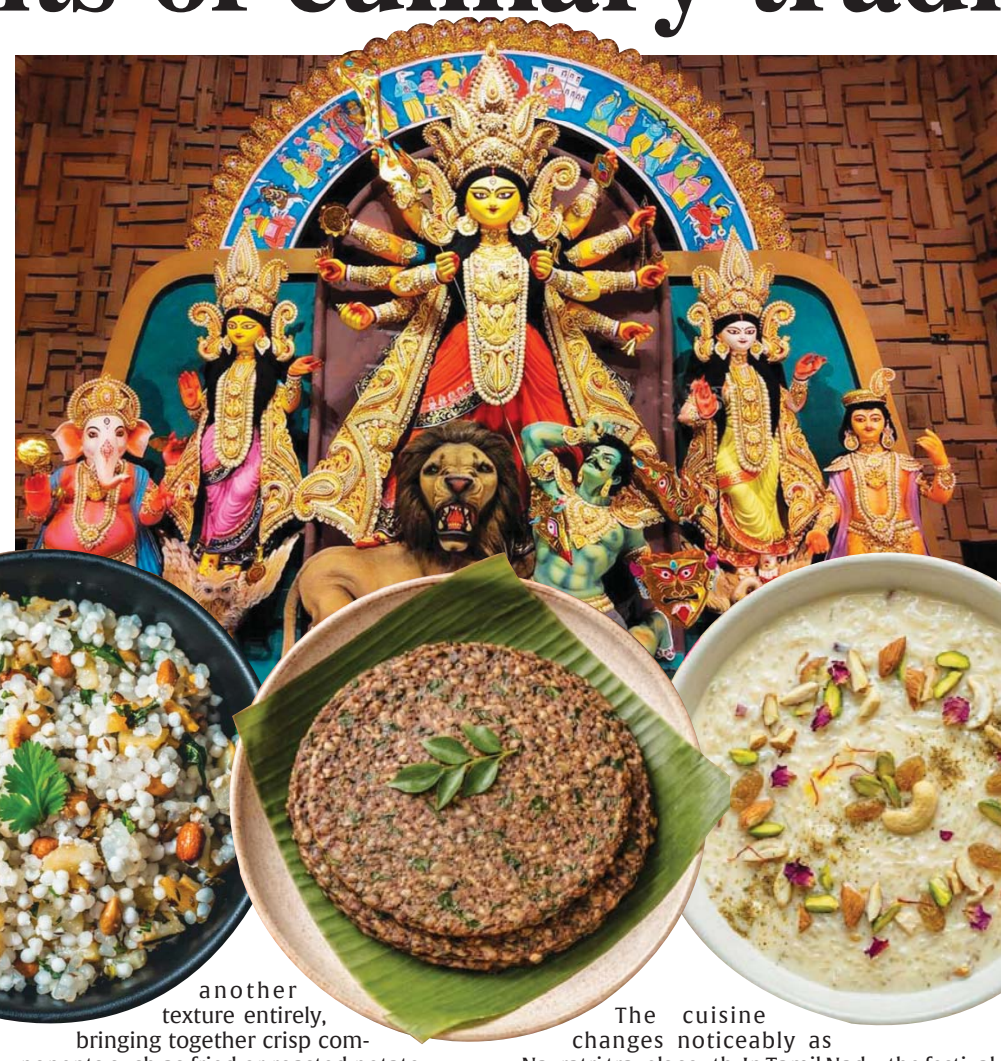
The writers are observers of the performing arts and cultural life

SHARAD NAVRATRI

The nine nights of culinary tradition



ANIL RAJPUT



Sharad Navratri is celebrated as a period of devotion to Shakti, the divine feminine power, and as a reaffirmation of the victory of righteousness over destructive forces. One of its central traditions recalls Goddess Durga's battle with Mahishasura, culminating in his defeat and symbolising the triumph of courage, dharma and divine strength. Across nine nights, devotees worship different manifestations of the Goddess, seeking qualities such as strength, wisdom, prosperity, courage and spiritual clarity.

As garba preparations begin, lamps are lit and homes fill with the sounds of prayer, another transformation is already taking place in the kitchen. Wheat flour may disappear from the countertop. Ordinary rice and table salt may be put aside. In their place arrive ingredients that, for many families, are used most intensely during periods of fasting: kuttu or buckwheat, singhara or water chestnut flour, rajgira or amaranth, samak or barnyard millet, sabudana, makhana, nuts, roots, dairy and sendha namak. Yet travel a few hundred kilometres and the Navratri kitchen changes again. In Tamil Nadu, chickpeas may be soaking for sundal to be offered to visitors who come to see the Golu. In Gujarat, farali snacks sit beside nights of garba. In Maharashtra, sabudana, peanuts and rajgira enter an entirely different repertoire. Sharad Navratri is therefore not represented by one festive plate. It is a festival during which many Indian kitchens temporarily rearrange their rules, ingredients and rhythms.

In 2026, Sharad Navratri begins on Sunday, 11 October, on Ashwin Shukla Pratipada. The first day is associated with Ghatasthapana, when a kalash is ceremonially established, and with the worship of Goddess Shailputri, the first of the nine forms of Durga honoured through Navratri. The festival belongs to Sharad Ritu, the autumn season from which it takes its name, and unfolds across nine nights before Vijayadashami on 20 October. While this spiritual framework binds the observance together, Navratri has never been confined to one cultural expression. Gujarat celebrates through garba and dandiya. Parts of northern India combine fasting and worship with the larger cultural landscape of the Ramayana and Ramlila. Maharashtra observes Ghatasthapana and household traditions of worship. In Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh, arrangements of dolls known as Golu or Bommai Golu become centres of visiting, music, prayer and exchange. In eastern India, the same sacred season gathers momentum towards the great celebrations of Durga Puja.

Food follows these regional differences, but one principle is especially striking in the fasting traditions of northern and western India. Navratri does not simply remove foods from the table. It creates another culinary system in their place. Families observing vrat commonly avoid cereal grains such as wheat and conventional rice, and many also set aside pulses, onion, garlic and ordinary salt. The precise rules differ by family, sect and region, but ingredients such as buckwheat, water chestnut, amaranth, barnyard millet, sago, milk, yoghurt, fruit, nuts and selected vegetables become unusually important. These are not merely replacements. Each behaves differently in the cook's hands, demanding knowledge that is often learned within the household.

Consider singhare ke atte ki mathi, a fasting counterpart to the crisp North Indian savoury. Water chestnut flour is combined with mashed potato, ghee and rock salt into a stiff dough, rested, rolled into small discs, pricked so that they remain crisp rather than puffing dramatically, and fried slowly until firm and golden. The same flour can be pushed much further in singhare ke atte ka samosa. Here the dough is cooked with water and ghee before it is shaped, while the filling can be made from soaked and coarsely ground chironji or charoli seeds, seasoned with cumin, cardamom, chilli and sendha namak. A familiar snack is thus reconstructed around the rules of the fast, but its character remains unmistakably festive.

Chironji produces another remarkable preparation in chironji ki dal. Although no conventional pulse is required, the small charoli seeds are soaked, rubbed to loosen their skins and partly ground. They are then cooked in ghee with cumin, ginger, green chilli and yoghurt until the mixture develops the comforting consistency associated with a dal. It is an excellent example of the ingenuity of the vrat kitchen: the aim is not simply to eat less, but to understand how permitted ingredients can assume entirely new roles. Colocasia, or arbi, offers similar possibilities. For arbi ki kadhi, cooked arbi and fasting flour can be used to create a tangy yoghurt preparation, with cumin, ginger and rock salt providing depth without the usual gram flour base.

Barnyard millet, variously called samak, sama, samvat or vrat ke chawal, creates another branch of Navratri cooking. Despite its rice-like appearance and common English nickname of "fasting rice", it is not ordinary rice. One particularly interesting preparation is vratwala chawal dhokla. The millet is soaked, ground and allowed to develop a light fermented character before being steamed into a soft, savoury cake. This is a clever fasting interpretation of a western Indian technique that normally relies on ingredients excluded during vrat. Samak can also be ground into a batter with singhara flour to make a thin samak dosa, cooked on a hot tawa until crisp at the edges and paired with a vrat-friendly filling or coconut-peanut chutney. Rather than reducing the fast to boiled food, such dishes show how fermentation, grinding and griddle cooking continue to create variation.

Gujarat contributes one of the richest farali repertoires. Farali pattice is especially revealing. Boiled raw banana, sweet potato or potato may form the outer covering, sometimes strengthened with singhara flour, while the centre holds a coarse mixture of roasted peanuts, sesame, coconut, coriander, ginger, chilli and a touch of sweetness and acidity. The sealed patties are fried until the exterior develops a crust and the centre remains soft and nutty. Farali chevdo offers another texture entirely, bringing together crisp components such as fried or roasted potato strands, peanuts, nuts and permitted seasonings into the sweet-salty balance loved in Gujarati snacks. Moraiyo, the Gujarati name commonly used for barnyard millet, can also become moraiyo dhokla, while rajgira flour can be worked into rajgira rotis or rajgira theplas served with yoghurt-based accompaniments. These dishes demonstrate that the language of farali food is not one of deprivation. It has its own techniques, flavours and pleasures.

Across Maharashtra, the fasting pantry intersects with a different culinary vocabulary. Upvasacha thalipeeth can be made by combining fasting flours or ground sabudana with potato, roasted peanut powder, chillies and cumin, then patting the mixture by hand into a flat disc and cooking it with ghee on a hot tawa. Sabudana vada, although now familiar across India, remains particularly at home in this western fasting tradition. Properly soaked sago pearls are mixed with crushed roasted peanuts, potato, cumin and green chilli before being shaped and fried. Its success depends on technique: too much water can make the sago sticky and heavy, while correct soaking allows the pearls to remain distinct and the exterior to turn crisp. Rajgira also appears as rajgira thalipeeth, rajgira roti and other crisp preparations, its nutty character making it more than a substitute flour.



The cuisine changes noticeably as Navratri travels south. In Tamil Nadu, the festival is closely associated with Golu, the tiered display of dolls and sacred or cultural figures arranged in homes. Visiting other households is part of the social rhythm, and sundal becomes inseparable from hospitality and prasadam. Kondakadalai sundal begins with chickpeas soaked and cooked until tender, then tossed in a tempering of mustard seeds, curry leaves and chillies before fresh coconut is folded through. Karamani sundal uses black-eyed peas, while pachai payaru sundal uses green gram. Other households may prepare peanut sundal. The principle is beautifully adaptable: the pulse changes, but the restrained tempering and fresh coconut allow each ingredient to retain its identity. These foods should not be forced into the rules of the North Indian vrat. They belong to another Navratri tradition in which an offering is prepared, shared with visitors and often varied from one evening to the next.

Sweetness, too, takes many forms during the nine nights. Rajgira laddoo is among the most recognisable, made by combining popped or roasted amaranth with melted jaggery so that the tiny seeds bind into light, crisp spheres. The same ingredient can become rajgira sheera, where its flour is roasted patiently in ghee until aromatic, then loosened with milk or water and sweetened before cardamom and nuts are added. Singhare ka halwa follows a similar principle but has its own texture: water chestnut flour is roasted in ghee before hot water or milk and sugar transform it into a glossy, dense sweet. Singhara can also become singhara barfi when cooked with milk or khoya, spread into a tray and allowed to set before being cut.

Makhana kheer offers a gentler contrast. Fox nuts are roasted in ghee, sometimes crushed lightly, then simmered in milk until they soften and the milk begins to thicken. Cardamom, nuts and saffron may complete the dish. Sabudana kheer uses soaked sago pearls instead, their translucence giving the milk pudding a completely different texture. Samak can also be simmered slowly with milk into samak kheer. Then there are sweets that transform vegetables and roots. Shakarkandi halwa cooks mashed sweet potato with ghee, milk and sugar until it becomes rich and cohesive, while kacche kele ki barfi turns raw banana into an unexpected confection by cooking it with milk, sugar and flavourings before setting it into pieces. Pumpkin halwa, slowly cooked with ghee and sweetener and finished with nuts, adds still another seasonal possibility. Together these dishes prevent Navratri sweetness from becoming dependent on a single grain, flour or technique.

Beverages form a quieter but important part of the fasting day. Depending on household custom, milk may be blended with almonds, saffron or cardamom to make badam milk, while lassi or lightly seasoned chaas can accompany permitted meals in families that consume yoghurt during vrat. Coconut water and fresh fruit drinks offer simpler refreshment, particularly when a fast extends across much of the day. Shikanji made with lemon, water, rock salt and permitted flavourings can be especially welcome in warmer regions, while nut and date milkshakes provide a richer option. As with the food itself, there is no universal Navratri drinks list. The household's fasting rules remain the final guide.

What makes this cuisine worth preserving is not simply the number of dishes attached to Navratri. It is the knowledge hidden inside them. Someone has to know that water chestnut flour will not behave like wheat. Someone has to judge how long sabudana should soak, how firmly farali pattice must be sealed, when amaranth has roasted enough for rajgira sheera, or how tender a chickpea should be before it enters a sundal. These details rarely survive through written recipes alone. They survive because one generation stands beside another in the kitchen and demonstrates them. That may be the most meaningful way to think about Sharad Navratri as it begins this year. The festival asks devotees to renew an ancient relationship with Shakti, discipline, community and faith, but its cuisine also asks us to renew a relationship with inherited knowledge. We can attend the garba, arrange the Golu, light the lamp and offer our prayers, but we should also invite younger hands into the kitchen, explain why ingredients change during these nine nights and teach the preparations that make each region's observance distinctive. Festivals endure when their rituals are remembered, but cultures remain alive when their skills are practised. If the next generation inherits Navratri without learning how its food is made, how much of the tradition will truly have been passed on?

(The writer is Secretary, Cuisine India Society)

The feast of the fast

As Navratri begins and kitchens switch to fasting food, a look at the ingredients behind the vrat thali and where they really come from

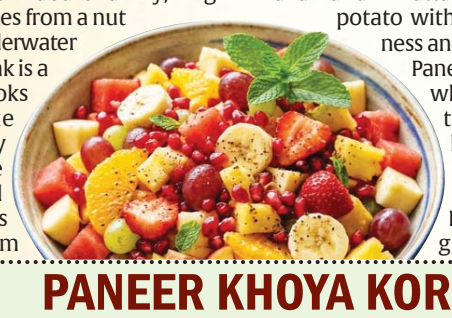
TEAM AGENDA



Sabudana is made from cassava starch. Cassava is a root that came to India from South America, and Salem in Tamil Nadu is the country's biggest centre for making sabudana

Everyone has been waiting for the pooja, and Navratri is finally here, with lamps lit for the evening aarti and kitchens switching to fasting mode. For nine nights, one for each form of Goddess Durga, many homes put away wheat, rice, lentils, onion and garlic, and even the salt is swapped for sendha namak, a type of rock salt traditionally used during fasting.

Few people stop to wonder where vrat food comes from. Kuttu, which most take for a grain, is the seed of a plant from the rhubarb family; singhara flour comes from a nut that grows underwater in ponds; samak is a millet that cooks so much like rice that many call it vrat ke chawal; and sabudana is made from cassava, a root that travelled to India from South America.



At Food Exchange in Novotel New Delhi Aerocity, Chef Bhupesh Singh builds his Navratri thali around these ingredients. It starts with Phalon Ki Chaat, seasonal fruit with a sprinkle of spices, followed by Aloo Mawa Ki Tikki, crisp on the outside with a soft centre made slightly sweet by the mawa, and Sabudana Ki Tikki, which gets its bite from green chilli and coriander.

The main course features Shakarkandi Khatta Meetha, sweet potato with a mix of tanginess and sweetness, and Paneer Khoya Korma, where khoya gives the gravy the body that onion usually would. Saunf Aur Petha Ki Sabzi is ash gourd, the vegetable Agra turns into its famous petha sweet, cooked with fennel. There is samak too, served as a vegetable pulao or plain with cumin, accompanied by kuttu and singhara puris, cool curd and crisp papads made from sabudana and makhana, the fox nut grown mostly in Bihar's ponds.

For dessert there is Sabudana Kheer, the kind many grew up eating at home, its pearls cooked in cardamom milk till they go clear, with nuts on top, and Rajgira Gur Ladoo made of jaggery and amaranth, known in Hindi as rajgira, or royal grain. Eating through a thali like this, the fast hardly feels like a restriction at all.

CHEF'S INSIGHTS

"Navratri food is about simplicity, balance and making the most of a few carefully chosen ingredients. This thali brings together familiar favourites prepared with seasonal produce and mindful cooking, while keeping the flavours comforting and celebratory. For me, the essence of Navratri lies in food that is uncomplicated, nourishing and rooted in tradition."
- Chef Bhupesh Singh

PANEER KHOYA KORMA

INGREDIENTS:
- Paneer 400 g
- khoya 100 g
- cashews 50 g
- fresh cream 100 ml
- ghee 40 g
- 3 green cardamom pods
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- sendha namak,
- saffron and water as required

METHOD:
- Heat ghee and gently cook the cashew paste.
- Add khoya and a little water to make a smooth gravy.
- Add cardamom, pepper and sendha namak.
- Add paneer and simmer for 5-7 minutes.
- Finish with fresh cream and saffron-infused water.
- Garnish with coriander or rose petals and serve hot.



From farm to plate in the Corbett foothills

GYANESHWAR DAYAL

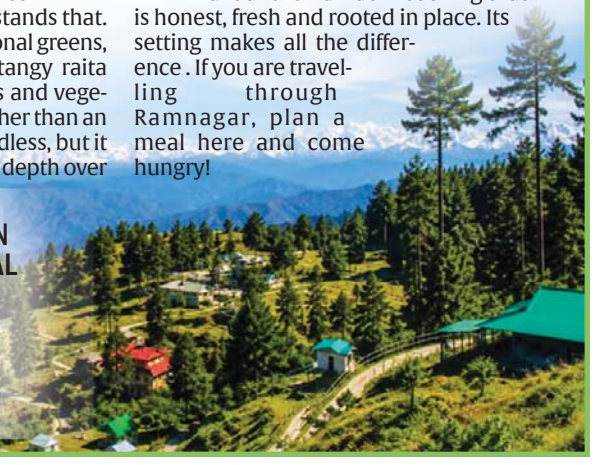


Kumaoni food rarely gets the stage it deserves. It is usually reduced to a token "pahadi thali" on a menu otherwise full of butter chicken. At Golden Tusk, on the edge of Ramnagar and the Jim Corbett region, it is the main event.

The cooking here is unhurried. The bhatt ki churkani, made with black soybeans simmered until thick and earthy, has the nutty depth that only slow cooking can bring. Aloo ke gutke, tossed with jakhya and dried red chillies, are simple, smoky and hard to stop eating. The dal is plain and comforting, and the chutneys are sharp enough to wake up the whole plate. Everything tastes of its ingredients rather than just masala. The spice is restrained, and the flavours are clean.

A good Kumaoni meal is built on contrast, and the spread here understands that. Hearty lentils sit beside light seasonal greens, rustic rotis alongside rice, and tangy raita beside fiery chutney. Meat-eaters and vegetarians alike get a proper meal rather than an afterthought. The menu is not endless, but it is honest and balanced, favouring depth over variety. What sets the kitchen of Golden Task apart is the source of its ingredients. Much of the produce, including vegetables, greens and herbs, is grown on the resort's own farm, and the resort says it is cultivated without chemical pesticides. You can taste the difference in the freshness. Tomatoes are sweet, greens are crisp and grassy, and the dishes need little else. A short journey from field to kitchen is rare, and it shows in every bite.

The setting suits the food. The meal is served in a calm, green space, surrounded by the quiet of the Corbett foothills and away from traffic and noise. The pace is slow, the service is warm, and nobody hurries you. Moreover as Golden Tusk is right in the buffer zone, ambiance is great to savour the Kumaoni cooking that is honest, fresh and rooted in place. Its setting makes all the difference . If you are travelling through Ramnagar, plan a meal here and come hungry!



KUMAONI CUISINE TAKES CENTRE STAGE AT GOLDEN TUSK, WHERE TRADITIONAL RECIPES, FARM-FRESH PRODUCE AND EARTHY FLAVOURS SHINE NEAR RAMNAGAR AND JIM CORBETT

Durga Conquers the Demons Within

AMMA (SRI MATA AMRITANANDAMAYI DEVI)



Children, the Puranas depict Durga and her shaktis killing many demons. Devi's sword is the sword of knowledge. It severs our selfish ego and its six heads: desire, anger, greed, attachment, pride and jealousy. Thus, Devi's sword is like the scalpel of a surgeon. It saves lives, never takes them. When the light of self-knowledge shines, the darkness of ignorance naturally fades away. Darkness cannot be destroyed with more darkness; only through light. So too, ignorance can only be destroyed through knowledge.

Thus, the demons that Devi kills represent our negative tendencies. To help vanquish these demonic forces from within us, we need divine intervention. It is said that Durga manifested from the combined energy of the divine powers of all the devas. The meaning here is that we will be able to defeat our deep-rooted negative tendencies and overcome their source, self-ignorance, only when we unify all of our positive qualities and fight with concentration and focus.

To bring God's grace into our lives, we need to awaken the attitude of taking only what we need and giving back to society. If we fail to do that, no matter how much we may gain materially, in reality the balance-sheet of our life will show nothing but a huge loss. In the end, we will leave the body full of sorrow and disappointment. So, we must awaken the attitude of seeing God in all and compassionately serving others.

Once a mother went to the supermarket to buy groceries with her son and daughter. In order to occupy them, she gave them both a few rupees and told them they could use the money however they liked. In this way, the mother knew they would be kept busy, and she would be able to do the household shopping in peace.

The son immediately bought a single chocolate bar and quickly sat down to eat it. The daughter thought for a bit and then bought a sapling to plant at home and a packet of biscuits. She then sat down next to her brother, who had already finished his chocolate bar, and shared her biscuits with him. The brother not only ate the biscuits his sister gave him, but also grabbed her share as well.

Here, the daughter did her part for Nature, took care of her own needs, and also fulfilled her duty to her sibling. This is the right attitude. However, currently the majority of us are living like the brother. All we know is how to take. We have to think carefully and decide what we should do with this precious human birth with which we have been blessed.

In God's creation, everything has a beneficial purpose. It is when we misuse objects that they bring destruction. For example, a car is useful, but when we speed, it can become a source of destruction. Nuclear power can also be used to help society through efficiently generating electricity. However, it can also be used to destroy entire nations. The freedom of choice — to engage in service or destruction – lies in each of our hands.

In order for all living beings to be able to coexist peacefully and for the world to progress, it is crucial that each of us, both women and men, invoke and awaken the principle of visvamatrtvam — Universal Motherhood. It resides in every human heart. The awakening of that unconditional love, compassion, and selflessness is the true meaning of Navaratri.

(Sri Mata Amritanandamayi Devi, known simply as Amma, is a spiritual master and humanitarian who has given her darshan in the form of a motherly embrace to more than 4 crore people. Listening to the cries of the suffering, Amma leads the Mata Amritanandamayi Math, an NGO that reaches across more than 50 countries, working in healthcare, disaster relief, education, gender equality, and environmental restoration)

दैव Daiv
SANCTUM
POWERED BY DAIV BHAKTI

Hatha Yoga — A Path to Liberation



SADHGURU

There are many dimensions to hatha yoga. One fundamental aspect of it is to knead the body. You know, if you make bread or chapati, you need to knead the dough well for it to turn out well. Similarly, the quality of your meditation depends on how well-kneaded you are, not only through hatha yoga or asanas but by life itself. Anyway, life is kneading you in so many ways. You can either enjoy it or suffer it. You can either mature and blossom, or get crushed by the process. This is the choice you have.

Hatha yoga is a kind of kneading — not just of the muscle but of every aspect of who you are. What you refer to as karma is embedded in every cell of the body and in every aspect of your energy. This becomes apparent when in the same process or activity, the energies of different individuals behave differently, depending on the type of memory their energy system carries. Kneading means trying to make your system so malleable that it has no power to influence you. You are taking charge of your life through the body. There are different ways to take charge of your life — one way is through the body. Physically, it may be a little harder, but it is a sure path, because you immediately know what works and what does not. If you try to take charge of your life through the mind, you do not know whether you are going forward or backward. You do not know whether you are becoming malleable or crusty. You may think you are doing well, but people around you may say otherwise.

The body never lies — that is a good thing about it. The mind tells you all kinds of lies, all the time. People who do not trust the mind start off with the body. Hatha yoga can be an ultimate path, because body, mind, energies, and being are not separate entities. You can approach the same thing from different ends. The physical entry is a sure way, but a longer one. It is not even harder, except you practice hatha yoga only every now and then. If you only do it once in a way, then bending may be a problem. If you do it every day, you will see sadhana is not hard at all. Hatha yoga is just one more doorway to ultimate liberation, but it is physical in nature. If you are in a good physical condition, it is effortless and a beautiful way to go. If you have asana siddhi, which means you can stay in a posture comfortably and stably for long periods of time, meditation will be effortless. If you struggle with meditation, it is because certain parts of the body and certain aspects of the mind do not cooperate as they should.

The problem is you have not trained your body and mind to remain in one posture or point. Sitting down on the floor, you realize in what state your body is. Hatha yoga means keeping everything in the system flowing. If you do the right kind of hatha yoga, you will live long, because you do not allow death to crop up in your system. Otherwise, rigor mortis is slowly creeping in — slowly, the body is becoming stiff. Hatha yoga can make meditation a joy. Likewise, if you train your mind to stay focused on something, meditation will be effortless. If both your body and your mind are well-trained, meditation will not be difficult. Hatha yoga can lead to asana siddhi. If you attain to asana siddhi, your body becomes still. You can simply sit there, and you will naturally become conscious.

Stillness is of many different levels. If you become totally still, you are in meditation, without any effort. The only effort is managing to sit in one place and to keep your mind where you want it to be. Right now, both the body and the mind are not listening to you - they are hopping all over the place. If I make you sit here for one-and-a-half hours, your legs will be telling their own story. If I make you sit for two hours or more, your bladder will be telling its own story. You will not care about heaven or enlightenment anymore — there will be only one place you want to go. For some people, it is food; for others, it is sexuality or some other physical compulsion that rules their lives. Once these compulsions come up, everything else get obliterated. There are many ways to fix this. Once, a young woman was in a cinema. While the movie was on, she went to the bathroom. When she came back, she tapped a man who was sitting at the end of the row on the shoulder and asked him, "Did I step on your toes when I left?" He said, "Yes," thinking she wants to apologize. She said, "Well, then this is my row." People display compulsions in so many different ways. When you have a body, some compulsions are there - you have to eat, sleep, go to the bathroom, and things like that — but that should not determine the direction of your life.

One meaning of the word hatha is being adamant. No matter if your body, mind, emotions, or your family like it or not, you get up in the morning and do your hatha yoga. It takes a certain adamancy to break the compulsiveness of your physical body. The body has a million years of evolutionary history behind it. It has its own tendencies, intentions, and compulsions. It will not give in easily. Generally, there are two meals a day in the ashram. Between the first meal at ten o'clock in the morning and the second one at seven o'clock in the evening, people get hungry. You come and sit in the Bhiksha Hall for dinner. The volunteers who are serving are taking their own time. Then the food is in front of you; you want to eat. The volunteers are doing the invocation slowly, but you wait until they are done.

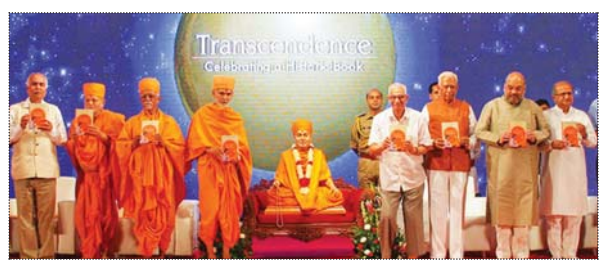
All this is part of hatha yoga. You are adamant about not only keeping the body aware but the mind too. The physical needs of the body are still there, but you slowly overcome the compulsiveness. If there is no compulsiveness in your system and you sit here, without the need for instructions, you are in meditation. What you are trying to work through are the compulsive cycles of karma. If you break all compulsiveness by using your body alone, it may take a certain amount of time and effort, but it is a fantastic thing to do. Hatha yoga is not just about bending and twisting the body. Essentially, it is about consciously working towards eliminating all that is compulsive in us — compulsions that we have carried on over millions of years of evolution. What distinguishes human beings and animals, or, in other words, the essence of being human is the possibility to move from compulsiveness to consciousness. Only if you transcend your compulsiveness completely, are you a full-fledged human. Otherwise, you are not a human being, you are a human becoming. We could call it "Project Human."

(Ranked amongst the fifty most influential people in India, Sadhguru is a Yogi, mystic, visionary and a New York Times bestselling author. Sadhguru has been conferred the Padma Vibhushan by the Government of India in 2017, the highest annual civilian award, accorded for exceptional and distinguished service. He is also the founder of the world's largest people's movement, Conscious Planet- Save Soil, which has touched over 4 billion people)

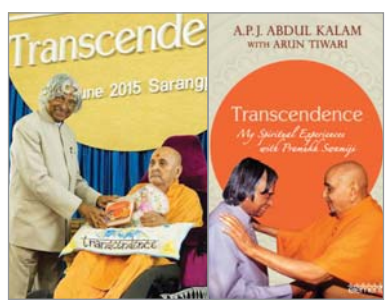


Transcendence

A great Indian scientist who explored the frontiers of the universe began an unexpected inner journey with Pramukh Swami Maharaj. Transcendence reveals how scientific brilliance found deeper meaning through spiritual awakening



DR SWAMI GYANANANDDAS



The world remembers Dr APJ Abdul Kalam as a brilliant scientist, the architect of India's missile programme, the 11th President of India and an inspiring thinker who awakened the dreams of millions. Yet, behind the celebrated scientist and statesman lived another Kalam, a quiet spiritual seeker, deeply concerned with the meaning of life, the nature of the self and the ultimate purpose of human existence.

As his birthday approaches on 15 October, perhaps the most meaningful way to remember this extraordinary son of India is to explore a lesser-known dimension of his personality: his spiritual journey. That journey brought him into the presence of many distinguished thinkers and spiritual personalities, but, by his own account, it reached its highest point in his relationship with Pramukh Swami Maharaj.

The finest window into this remarkable relationship is '*Transcendence: My Spiritual Experiences with Pramukh Swamiji*', the final book authored by Dr Kalam with Professor Arun Tiwari. The book records fourteen years of Kalam's spiritual experiences and friendship with Pramukh Swami Maharaj. Dr Kalam regarded Pramukh Swami Maharaj as his "ultimate teacher" and described his influence as the culmination of his spiritual ascent.

Their first meeting took place in Delhi on 30 June 2001. Kalam arrived with his colleague YS Rajan, seeking guidance for his vision of India's development. What unfolded was more than an intellectual conversation. It became a meeting of science and spirituality.

There was, however, an amusing barrier between the two: Kalam spoke English, while Pramukh Swami Maharaj spoke Gujarati. Yet language proved powerless to obstruct a bond formed at the level of the heart. Affection, humility and spiritual kinship required neither grammar nor vocabulary.

Kalam was deeply struck by the divine presence. In Transcendence, he describes the extraordinary impression Pramukh Swami Maharaj made upon him at their first meeting. The divine guru's simplicity, radiance and serenity created an atmosphere in which Kalam felt something far beyond an ordinary human interaction.

As their relationship deepened, Kalam began experiencing the divine presence even when he was physically absent. He wrote, "Our connection was getting deeper, and I could sense Pramukh Swamiji's presence even in his absence." This was not merely admiration for a religious personality; it was the experience of a seeker who had discovered a spiritual anchor.

One of the most beautiful episodes occurred at Rashtrapati Bhavan. While walking through its gardens, Kalam encountered a peacock displaying its magnificent feathers. The sight reminded him of Pramukh Swami Maharaj. He wished that Swamishri would one day come to Rashtrapati Bhavan with hundreds of sadhus, sanctifying the presidential residence through their presence, prayers and spiritual atmosphere.

When Kalam telephoned Swamishri, the latter was in Mumbai and was not keeping well. Kalam requested that, once his health improved, he should visit Rashtrapati Bhavan. Pramukh Swami Maharaj replied with words that profoundly moved him: "Whenever you remember me, I am with you in Rashtrapati Bhavan."

For Kalam, this answer seemed to transcend the limitations of time and space. The physical presence of a person is governed by distance; spiritual presence is experienced through remembrance.

In 2004, Kalam visited Akshardham in Gandhinagar for the golden jubilee celebrations of the BAPS Bal Mandal. At the conclusion of the programme, Pramukh Swami Maharaj quietly walked behind him for some distance to see him off. Surprised, Kalam asked why Swamishri had come so far to bid him farewell. Swamiji simply replied, "You have come all the way from Delhi to here."

Those simple words moved Kalam deeply. He saw a humility untouched by position, achievement or fame.

Their friendship ultimately reached a remarkable culmination on 20 June 2015, when Kalam travelled to Sarangpur and personally presented Transcendence to Pramukh Swami Maharaj. The book, which documented fourteen years of their spiritual relationship, had come full circle.

On that occasion, Kalam told Swamishri, "You are a great teacher. From you I've learnt to eradicate I-ness and My-ness in life."

The moment carried a poignant sense of completion. Only weeks later, on 27 July 2015, Dr Kalam passed away in Shillong. Pramukh Swami Maharaj followed him to Akshardham just over a year later, on 13 August 2016.

The story of Kalam and Pramukh Swami Maharaj is therefore much more than the friendship of a scientist and a swami. It is the story of two great lives meeting at the intersection of knowledge and wisdom, achievement and humility, science and spirituality.

And as we approach Dr Kalam's birthday this 15 October, perhaps we should remember not only the scientist who taught India to dream, but also the spiritual seeker who taught us that the highest human journey is not merely towards greater knowledge, but towards greater humility, purity and God-consciousness.

It was, indeed, a divine bondbetween a sadhu and a scientist, between spiritual wisdom and scientific brilliance, and between two extraordinary souls who transcended the boundaries of language, position and circumstance.

(Dr Swami Gyanananddas is a dedicated follower of the Swaminarayan tradition and has earned a PhD from MS University)

World Mental Health Day: Where Is Your Mind?



GURUDEV SRI SRI RAVI SHANKAR

Nothing in the world can bother you as much as your own mind, I tell you. In fact, others seem to be bothering you, but it is not others; it is your own mind.

Yet, there is still a lot of stigma attached to mental health. People suffering from mental health conditions often do not want to talk about it or seek help for fear of judgment. We must do away with all types of stigma attached to mental health. People go to the gym to keep a robust body. The rise of Yoga studios has shown that people are not just looking to be physically fit but mentally fit as well. We brush every day to take care of our dental hygiene; similarly, we need to take care of our mental hygiene too. Meditation is for mental hygiene what brushing is for the teeth.

Health is not just the absence of disease. It is a positive state of well-being. Fortunately, today we hear a lot of talk about wellness and lifestyle changes. But when it comes to the mind, we still wait for illness to arrive. It is necessary to take a preventive step rather than trying to cure.

Health is complete when it attends to four aspects-physical, mental, social, and spiritual. You may be physically fit but mentally weak. You may be mentally fit but physically not that strong. Then there is the social factor, where a person's behaviour in society is not palatable. Many people struggle to make new connections, and the few they have, they cannot keep them. This is a lack of social health. Spiritual health is the broad vision of who one is and what life is all about. Our feelings are not in our control, and they change with time. One day you feel secure; the next you feel insecure. The mind is like that. You never know what type of feelings will come. People say, "I can't live without you." A few years later, they say, "I can't stand you." It is the same person! Our emotions are constantly changing, but when they come over you, you do not know how to handle them. We have been told not to get angry, not to be sad. But neither in school nor in our homes have we been taught how to handle these challenging emotions.

Today there is a global epidemic of loneliness. In the UK, there is a dedicated Loneliness Ministry to address it at a policy level.

It is normal to feel alone. Even those who have riches, a good family, and a loving partner can still feel lonely. When you find that life is meaningless, a sense of emptiness dawns on you. This can either take you towards depression, or the same emptiness can become a vehicle for you to rise to a higher consciousness, once you know how to take care of this mind.

To have robust mental health, we need to know what the mind is, how it functions, and where it is. Recently, scientists have said that the mind is not in the brain but all over the body. Usually, we think our mind is inside the body. But actually, the body is inside the mind. The mind is bigger than the body. Once you see this, you understand what happens within you when you are happy, and what happens when you are not. When someone says, "You are so good-looking," you feel yourself expanding. Whenever you are happy, your mind expands. And when you feel unhappy, the mind shrinks. You feel something is crushing, something is shrinking. You feel hopeless, as if nothing is working. That is the negative energy of a shrinking mind.

When this shrinking increases further, people want to harm themselves. What shrinks is the life force, or the prana. The subtle body becomes smaller than the physical body. It is like a scarf tightening around the neck. You want to remove it. When prana goes this low, suicidal tendencies arise. But suicide doesn't really help. It is like someone stepping out in severe cold and removing the jacket.

But with just a few minutes of breathing, meditation, and dance, the subtle body comes back to its normal shape. These activities help increase the prana, or the life force energy. Your breath has a message for you. It says, "I am here, flowing in and out of you day and night. Why don't you give me a little attention? If you give me attention, I will make you happy."

Just look at a baby, the way it breathes, the way it smiles, the way it connects. A baby is crying one moment and laughing the next, from every cell of its body. Babies have not yet accumulated stress. As you grow up, these qualities get covered in stress, tension, and too many impressions. You do not realise you are breathing unless you run to catch a bus or get a cold.

There is a rhythm in nature, in the seasons, and in the body too. We feel hungry and sleepy at certain times. Each emotion creates a certain sensation in a certain part of the body. This is linked to a rhythm in the breath. When you are happy or smell a flower, the inhalation is slow, steady, and strong. When you are sad or grieving, the exhalation is longer and the breath heavier. If we know something about our breath, we can manage our emotions very well.

If the mind is a kite, the breath is the thread. The longer the thread, the higher the kite can go. With the practice of Sudarshan Kriya, a powerful breathing technique, you can remove stress from every body cell and cleanse negativity. Doctors from America, Canada, and Japan shared the impact that Sudarshan Kriya and meditation have had on the mental health of patients around the globe.

For fear and anxiety, do Ujjayi breath for a few minutes. Breathe in and out through the nose while constricting your throat. You will see all the knots in the heart region open up, and then the fear disappears. Anxiety and fear are connected to the heart region. Lift the energy from there. When it is stuck, it is like ploughing snow to get your car moving.

Breathing practices help us go deeper into meditation, and meditation calms an anxious mind. To meditate effortlessly, I give three principles. You simply need to keep these in mind, without much effort. The first is, 'I want nothing.' When you sit to meditate, bundle up all your desires and keep them aside. You can have them back later. Second is, 'I do nothing.' Meditation is not about focusing, chasing thoughts away, or trying to concentrate. You have to just let go. The third principle is, 'I am nothing.' We put so many labels on ourselves- I am intelligent, I am stupid, I am rich, I am poor... Drop all of these labels. For those few moments, be nobody. When you say I want nothing, I do nothing, I am nothing, the mind becomes free. You slip into that beautiful space of nothingness, and that nothing is the basis of everything.

On this World Mental Health Day, let us take a vow to help all those in need. If you walk down the street and find someone unhappy, you should not just pass by. Wherever possible, stop and exchange a few words with them. It may seem a little strange in the beginning. But when you start doing it, you will be helping people tremendously. In many parts of India and the world, the Art of Living volunteers went door to door asking people, "Are you happy?" Many said it was the first time someone had asked. That question itself kindles so much comfort and such a positive emotion in the other. Let us find that happiness within ourselves and bring happiness to people around us.